

IN THE NEWS

COMPANIES | PAGE 4

COFORGE CRISIS DEEPENS AS DIRECTOR QUILTS



THE CRISIS AT IT firm Coforge deepened with non-executive independent director and nomination and remuneration committee chairperson D K Singh resigning on Friday, citing "differences and tension" between independent and executive directors, days after Chairman OP Bhatt resigned over issues in board reporting.

ECONOMY | PAGE 3

INDIA, EU MOVE CLOSER TO LANDMARK FTA



THE INDIA-EUROPEAN Union free trade agreement has moved another step towards becoming operational, with the European Commission proposing a formal European Council decision authorising the signing of the pact and a separate decision for its conclusion, reports Mukesh Jagota.

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FOREX RESERVES JUMP TO A LIFETIME HIGH | PAGE 3

Bond yield tops 7%, highest in over 3 months



GOVERNMENT BONDS fell this week as surging oil prices, a global debt rout, and concerns over the RBI's liquidity stance pushed the benchmark yield above 7%, wiping out gains from the central bank's June measures to attract dollars, reports Reuters. The yield jumped 5 basis points to 7.0233%, its highest in more than three months. ■ PAGE 6

India crude basket hits \$115.98, OMC margins shrink



STATE-RUN OIL retailers face a renewed squeeze on fuel marketing margins, LPG under-recoveries and working capital as crude prices remain above \$100 a barrel, even after a sharp pullback on Friday, reports Saurav Anand. India's crude basket stands at \$115.98 a barrel. ■ PAGE 2



(From extreme left) Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian, Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Russian President Vladimir Putin and South African President Cyril Ramaphosa at the BRICS Business Forum in New Delhi on Friday

PM calls for stronger BRICS trade ties and secure seas

Stresses freedom of navigation and seafarers' safety as wars upend trade

MUKESH JAGOTA
New Delhi, September 11

GLOBAL TRADE CAN advance only if navigation in international waters is free and seafarers are safe, Prime Minister Narendra Modi said on Friday. The statement comes in the wake of the prolonged — and often severe — disruptions in the Strait of Hormuz amid the US-Iran conflict, and the escalation it caused to global energy prices.

Addressing the Business Forum ahead of the 18th BRICS Summit in New Delhi, Modi called for the 11-country grouping to turn its growing economic weight into greater investment and expanded businesses. He urged the grouping to identify and remove its top 10 trade barriers, scale 100 BRICS startups into other

member markets every year and build 1,000 new business partnerships annually.

Modi also highlighted India's efforts to diversify supply chains and build capacity in strategic sectors such as shipbuilding, semiconductors, quantum technology, critical minerals and biotechnology. "Make in India, Innovate with India, and Scale for the World," he told the gathering.

The Prime Minister's remarks come at a time when conflicts in West Asia and the Black Sea have increasingly exposed merchant shipping and their crews to missile and drone attacks. At least 10 Indian seafarers died in the West Asia conflict, the government had informed Parliament in late July. Around five deaths of Indian seafarers have been reported in attacks on commercial vessels in the Black Sea region that falls under the shadow of Russia-Ukraine conflict. There has been reported loss of at least one India-flagged vessel near Yemen.

Continued on Page 7

Modi, Putin review ties as oil discount shrinks

FE BUREAU
New Delhi, September 11

PRIME MINISTER NARENDRA Modi and Russian President Vladimir Putin on Friday reviewed bilateral ties, focusing on expanding economic and industrial cooperation amid geopolitical disruptions and growing trade and energy linkages. The two leaders met on the sidelines of the 18th BRICS Summit in New Delhi, their second meeting this year after talks in Bishkek on August 31 on the margins of the SCO Summit.

The next major engagement will be the 24th India-Russia Annual Summit in Russia. Putin invited Modi to visit Russia for the summit, and the Prime Minister accepted the invitation. The dates will be finalised later.

The discussions on Friday covered trade and investment,

defence, energy, space, skill mobility and people-to-people ties. They welcomed Russia's International Industrial Exhibition, INNOPROM India, held in New Delhi from September 9 to 11, and visited the exhibition,

underscoring efforts to expand the relationship beyond its traditional pillars of defence and energy.

Russian crude remains at the heart of that equation. Russia accounted for an average 43.3% of India's crude imports during April-July 2026, with its share touching a record 51% in July. The oil trade, however, moderated in August. India's Russian crude imports fell 26.3% month-on-month to 2.08 million barrels per day (bpd) from a record 2.82 million bpd in July.

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NSE IPO: Shares priced at ₹1,700-1,785 apiece

KUSHAN SHAH
Mumbai, September 11

THE NATIONAL STOCK Exchange (NSE) will launch its much-awaited ₹22,000-crore initial public offering (IPO) on September 17, marking a key milestone for the country's largest stock exchange more than three decades after it began operations.

The issue is entirely an offer-for-sale (OFS) and comprises 126.44 million shares in a price band of ₹1,700-1,785 apiece. This values the offer at ₹21,494-22,568 crore. At the upper end of the price band, it will be the second-biggest public issue after Hyundai Motor India. The red herring prospectus (RHP) saw the size of the OFS reduced from 148.91 million shares to 126.44 million shares, as several corporate shareholders cut the number of shares they planned to sell.

NSE Managing Director and Chief Executive Officer Ashishkumar Chauhan highlighted on Friday the exchange's transformation from handling about 700 trades on its first day of operations in 1994 to around 300 million trades on a busy day now. "NSE is India's largest exchange and, by many counts,

PECKING ORDER

Company	Year	IPO size (₹ cr)
Hyundai Motor India	2024	27,859
NSE*	2026	21,494-22,568
LIC	2022	20,557
One 97 Comm. (Paytm)	2021	18,300
Tata Capital	2025	15,512
Coal India	2010	15,199

* Valuation based on price band of ₹1,700-1,785 apiece
Source: Prime Database

ASHISHKUMAR CHAUHAN, MD & CEO, NSE

In the long run, India's growth, demographics, and technological adoption will prevail. What you see is a short-term blip



it's one of the largest in the world. The purpose of NSE was also to channel savings into capital. It's a testament that NSE has fulfilled the mandate its founders started with," he said. NSE began equity market operations on November 3, 1994, and has since expanded across asset classes while building much of the technology underpinning its trading

infrastructure. "We are among the largest vertically integrated exchanges in the sense that we own our technology. Some exchanges focus on commodities or equities. We are across asset classes — commodities, currencies, electricity, even charity," Chauhan said.

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GLOBAL FINTECH FEST

FM: Need stronger guardrails against agentic AI threats

NIRMALA SITHARAMAN, FINANCE MINISTER

Our goal should be neither to block innovation out of fear nor to let speed compromise safety



FE BUREAU
New Delhi, September 11

FINANCE MINISTER NIRMALA Sitharaman on Friday warned that the rapid adoption of agentic AI, tokenisation and quantum computing could create new systemic risks if technological progress outpaces safeguards, calling for stronger accountability, oversight and institutional preparedness.

"As we rapidly progress into the era of agentic AI, tokenisation, and quantum computing, we all need to ask a critical question to ourselves: how do we balance breakthrough efficiency against emerging systemic risk?" Sitharaman said, addressing the 7th Global Fintech Fest in Mumbai.

Acknowledging the trans-

»INSIDE«
PAYMENT PROVIDERS NEED QUANTUM-PROOFING, SAYS RBI DG P6

BANKS CAN'T DO IT ALL, PLENTY LEFT FOR FINTECHS: BANSAL P6

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NDB reform, more local-currency trade sought

FE BUREAU
New Delhi, September 11

FINANCE MINISTERS AND central bank governors of BRICS countries on Friday pitched for greater use of national currencies for cross-border trade and investment. They also pledged to intensify efforts to reform global financial institutions, expand development finance, strengthen the New Development Bank (NDB), mobilise private capital and improve payment systems amid rising

KEY TAKEAWAYS

■ Unilateral imposition of trade, financial actions, including raising of tariffs and non-tariff measures, is concerning

■ IMF, World Bank should have higher representation of emerging markets and developing economies

■ Risks to global economic outlook remain elevated, reflecting persistent geopolitical tensions, protectionism, and growing debt



global economic uncertainties. In a joint statement after their meeting in Mumbai, the

grouping acknowledged the efforts of the BRICS Payment Task Force towards exploring

»INSIDE«

BRICS MEMBERS SHOULD LINK PAYMENT SYSTEMS: GOYAL P2

RUSSIA, IRAN SEEK MORE FINANCING P2

INDIA, CHINA SHOULD HANDLE DIFFERENCES PROPERLY: BEIJING AHEAD OF MODI-XI MEET P2

RUSSIAN HACKING, CHINESE CLAUDE MISUSE & YEMENI MISSILE DEVELOPMENT ATTEMPTS BLOCKED, SAYS FIRM

Anthropic flags bids to use AI to build biological weapons

AJ VICENS & EDUARDO BAPTISTA
September 11

ANTHROPIC BROKE UP attempts to use its Claude models to develop biological weapons and carry out a suspected Russia-linked cyber espionage campaign against Ukraine, the AI heavyweight said in its latest Threat Intelligence report. It also accused Chinese competitors of hacking attempts aimed at extracting Claude's capabilities.

In its report, which documented malicious use of its technology over the past eight months, Anthropic said it has long been a concern that AI models might one day reach the level of capability where

THREAT ANALYSIS

Biological weapons: Anthropic report documents five attempts of using its AI models in ways that could support biological weapons development. Firm did not identify the actors

Illicit distillation: Anthropic says it disrupted distillation attempts by seven China-based labs, including Alibaba, Moonshot and DeepSeek

Conventional weapons: Attempted use of Claude to develop software for conventional weapons, including missiles & armed drones

Surveillance & espionage: One hacking group reportedly ran operations against targets in Ukrainian government, military

they could help make existing pathogens more dangerous or create entirely new ones. It documented five examples of scientists using its models in ways that could support bio-

logical weapons development. In one case, a researcher in a region unsupported by Anthropic employed virtual private server infrastructure to access Claude and for weeks

used it to plan avian influenza mammalian-adaptation experiments. Regions not supported by Anthropic include countries like Russia, China and North Korea among others.

After detecting the misuse, it banned the accounts involved. Anthropic did not identify the institutions, the countries where they are based, or the specific biological agents and research techniques involved.

It also identified what it called "new categories of threat actors" misusing Claude. That included using the platform to "develop software for conventional weapons, including firearms, missiles, armed drones, bombs, and other munitions, as well as the targeting and control systems that operate them." The report detailed incidents of operators in China, Russia and Yemen using Claude to develop software for weapons design and development, or to support intelligence gathering

and procurement related to weapons programmes.

Rapid improvements in Anthropic's models have raised new risks, Jacob Klein, its head of threat intelligence, told Reuters.

Anthropic found that cybercriminals and state-backed hackers were increasingly using AI to orchestrate and execute large portions of cyberattacks, with humans often serving as overseers rather than hands-on operators. One hacking group allegedly ran phishing, hotel Wi-Fi hijacking and WhatsApp takeover operations against targets in the Ukrainian government, military and diplomatic sectors, using AI at nearly every stage, Anthropic said.

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Open to slowing frontier AI development: Altman

OPENAI IS CONSIDERING slowing down the development of cutting-edge artificial intelligence, and the ChatGPT maker's Chief Executive Officer Sam Altman is hoping other AI companies will do the same, reports Bloomberg.

In a company-wide meeting this week, Altman told employees that OpenAI could potentially pace its AI development, perhaps in conjunction with several other AI labs, but that some may not agree to do so, according to people familiar with the matter.

In recent weeks, employees of leading AI firms have raised public concerns about the increased risks of advanced AI systems, fuelling anxiety inside these companies. Both OpenAI and its rival Anthropic have filed confidential paperwork to go public earlier this year.

OpenAI declined to comment. The company's top scientist, Jakub Pachocki, recently wrote a post warning about the dangers of AI and said he believes AI companies should be "coordinating to slow down future development as needed."



SPEED
READ



Modi holds talks with Iranian Prez

PRIME MINISTER NARENDRA Modi on Friday hosted Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian for talks to review the overall situation in West Asia and chart a path for expanded bilateral relations, marking their second meeting in less than two weeks. The talks took place hours after the Iranian leader arrived in the national capital to attend the BRICS summit.



BRICS exports rise to \$6 trn in 2024

COMMERCE AND INDUSTRY Minister Piyush Goyal on Friday said exports from BRICS countries have risen from about \$900 billion in 2003 to \$6 trillion in 2024, reflecting the scale of its market and potential. Goyal also said the share of BRICS nations in global exports has nearly doubled to about 24%.



Russia backs global energy security

RUSSIA STANDS READY to contribute to global energy and food security, President Vladimir Putin said on Friday, highlighting that BRICS countries have dynamic and vibrant domestic markets. He said said the world is under-going deep, and profound shifts. — AGENCIES

Sberbank sees digital currencies as next step in trade settlements

FE BUREAU
New Delhi, September 11

RUSSIA'S BIGGEST LENDER, Sberbank, sees digital currencies playing a bigger role in India-Russia trade settlements as it expands its business ecosystem in India to support trade, investment and corporate partnerships, Chief Executive Officer Herman Gref said on Friday.

"It's only the beginning, but we see huge opportunities for digital currencies in settlements between the countries," Gref said, adding that such transactions could become more efficient and attract greater demand than digital currency applications within individual countries.

The Russian central bank and the Reserve Bank of India are working on the issue, Gref said, adding that Sberbank was seeking to support the development of such instruments.

Sberbank has more than

MINISTER SAYS EXPAND TRADE IN NATIONAL CURRENCIES AND OPEN MARKETS TO EACH OTHER

BRICS should link payment systems: Goyal

MUKESH JAGOTA
New Delhi, September 11

COMMERCE AND INDUSTRY Minister Piyush Goyal on Friday called upon the BRICS countries to link their payment systems, expand trade in national currencies and open markets to each other, as the grouping seeks to build more resilient supply chains amid growing trade and geopolitical uncertainties. Addressing the opening session of the BRICS Business Forum, a day ahead of the 18th BRICS Summit in New Delhi, Goyal said members should work towards making digital trade global while jointly developing capabilities in emerging technologies.

Highlighting India's Unified Payments Interface (UPI), Goyal said the home-grown digital payment system now processes more than 250 billion transactions a year, accounting for more than half of global transactions by volume. UPI is currently accepted in 11 countries, he said.

The push for greater use of local currencies was backed by Russia's Minister of Economic Development Maxim Reshetnikov. He said the share of Russia's exports settled in US dollars and euros had fallen sharply from 85% three years ago to 11% currently.

"An alternative international financial system became our key leverage," Reshetnikov said, adding that it now links thousands of banks across several countries and has further scope for expansion.

He said Russia's "friendly

partners" now account for 85% of its total trade turnover, twice the level recorded in 2021. For India, strengthening BRICS supply chains has particular significance amid concerns over China's export controls on strategic and critical minerals and rare-earth products needed for electric vehicles, renewable energy and defence industries.

Goyal urged BRICS members to open their markets to each other, including for raw materials and critical minerals. "Our supply chains will be resilient when they run both ways," he said.

India faced an acute supply squeeze in rare-earth magnets following China's tighter export controls in 2025. While supplies to Indian manufacturers have eased, concerns remain over the reliability and continuity of supplies, particularly as demand for these materials is expected to rise with the expansion of clean-energy and advanced manufacturing sectors.

Goyal also flagged non-tariff barriers as a major impediment to trade, saying regulatory requirements can impose costs higher than tariffs themselves. He called on BRICS members and partner countries to simplify regulations and facilitate faster clearance of consignments.

"Let us also encourage our agri-tech startups to develop solutions together for farmers across the BRICS nations in the interest of food security for our people," he said, while also calling for greater opening of services markets.

Gref said Sberbank wants to help address the imbalance in bilateral trade, with about \$50 billion currently accumulated on the Russian side. Its priority is to boost Indian exports to Russia while facilitating Russian investment and business in India.

The bank had previously faced challenges from surplus Indian rupees in vostro accounts, but Gref said the issue had been resolved.

"Previously, we had problems with surplus rupees, but we have now found the right ways to utilise the rupee balances. It is no longer a problem in our trade," he said.

Sberbank also sees strong medium- and long-term prospects for Russian investors in India, partly as a way to manage currency risk.

subsidary Rabota.ru, focuses on recruitment between India and Russia, where a labour shortage has created demand for workers.

Sberbank also plans to establish a 24,000-square-metre business centre in New Delhi that will house its headquarters and serve as a hub for major Russian companies operating in India.

The bank is discussing



External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar, Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal and others during the opening ceremony of the BRICS Business Forum 2026, in New Delhi on Friday

Russia, Iran seek bigger BRICS financing to counter sanctions

MUKESH JAGOTA
New Delhi, September 11

RUSSIA AND IRAN on Friday called for strengthening BRICS financial and trade mechanisms, including an expanded role for the New Development Bank (NDB), greater use of local currencies and new instruments to mobilise private capital, as geopolitical tensions and sanctions disrupt global trade and investment.

Addressing the BRICS Business Forum, Russian President Vladimir Putin proposed setting up a new investment platform backed by private-sector funding to improve the competitiveness of the bloc's 11 member economies.

Iranian President Masoud



MoS for Shipping and Waterways Shantanu Thakur receives Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian in New Delhi

Pezeshkian said the NDB should become the principal engine for financing infrastructure and energy projects through dedicated credit lines, local-currency financing and guarantees to attract private capital.

Pezeshkian also proposed a BRICS joint reinsurance company with an initial capital of \$10 billion to cover risks associated with major infrastructure and energy projects and boost private-sector confidence.

India, China should handle differences properly: Beijing

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Beijing, September 11

AHEAD OF PRESIDENT Xi Jinping's visit to India for the BRICS summit and bilateral talks with Prime Minister Narendra Modi, China on Friday said both countries should handle differences properly and view their ties from a strategic and long-term perspective. Xi will arrive in Delhi on Saturday to attend the BRICS summit, his first visit to India in nearly seven years. He is scheduled to hold a bilateral meeting with PM Modi on the sidelines of the summit on Saturday.

Asked how China viewed the Modi-Xi meeting, foreign ministry spokesperson Mao Ning told a media briefing here that this will be the third year in a row for the two leaders to meet with each other, following their meetings in Kazan and Tianjin.

"China will work with India to act on the strategic guidance of the two leaders, handle the bilateral relations from a strategic height and long-term per-

HIGH HOPES



■ President Xi Jinping will arrive in New Delhi today to attend the BRICS summit

■ He is scheduled to hold a bilateral meeting with PM Modi on the sidelines of the summit

spective, step up communication, enhance cooperation, properly handle differences, and be friends enjoying good-neighbourliness and partners helping each other succeed," she said.

About the BRICS summit, Mao said it is a key platform for solidarity and cooperation among emerging markets and developing countries.

"President Xi will attend and address the upcoming

summit, have in-depth exchanges with other leaders on major issues including the current international situation, the development of BRICS mechanisms, and deepening practical cooperation, and put forward China's important initiatives and propositions, charting the course for the high-quality development of greater BRICS cooperation," she said.

She said that China is ready to work with fellow BRICS countries for steady and sustained progress in greater BRICS cooperation to contribute to building a community with a shared future for humanity.

About the significance of the New Delhi summit, which is taking place amid the Iran-US conflict and the Ukraine-Russia war, Mao said China advocates a common, comprehensive, cooperative, and sustainable approach to security.

"We are committed to promoting the political settlement of hotspot issues through dialogue," she said.



S JAISHANKAR,
EXTERNAL AFFAIRS MINISTER

The objective is to strengthen our ability to absorb shocks while remaining connected and competitive



MASOUD PEZESHKIAN,
IRAN PRESIDENT

BRICS must create an environment in which no country can disrupt the legitimate trade of another country through monopolising



G KISHAN REDDY,
MINISTER OF MINES

In BRICS Summit, critical minerals is one of the major agendas, and discussions will be held around that



SHASHI THAROOR,
SENIOR CONGRESS LEADER

We want BRICS to be a forum that is non-West, but not anti-West. That is not exactly the same agenda as every other country

HPCL most vulnerable as crude spike sends India basket over \$115

SAURAV ANAND
New Delhi, September 11

INDIA'S THREE STATE-RUN oil marketing companies (OMCs) face a renewed squeeze on fuel marketing margins, LPG under-recoveries and working capital as crude prices remain above \$100 a barrel, even after a sharp pullback on Friday.

Brent crude futures fell \$3.28, or 3.05%, to \$104.35 a barrel at 1309 GMT on Friday, while US West Texas Intermediate declined \$3.41, or 3.33%, to \$99.07. Both benchmarks touched their highest levels since mid-May earlier in the session, while Brent remained on course for a weekly gain of more than 8%.

For Indian refiners, the cost pressure is sharper. The Indian crude basket stood at \$115.98 a barrel on September 9, while

its September average rose to \$104.09 a barrel through September 9, up 15.4% from \$90.19 in August and sharply above \$82.04 in July. The \$104.09 figure is the latest September average supported by PPAC-linked published data.

Among the three OMCs, the impact could be sharpest on Hindustan Petroleum Corporation (HPCL), followed by Indian Oil Corporation (IOCL), while Bharat Petroleum Corporation (BPCL) is relatively better placed if crude remains elevated and retail fuel prices see restricted increases, according to Equirus Securities. HPCL has a 51% refining-to-marketing ratio and 76% distillate yield, along with the lowest internal refining cover among the three.

Greater dependence on purchased or imported prod-

MARGINS COME UNDER PRESSURE

■ State-run oil marketing companies face a renewed squeeze on fuel marketing margins, LPG under-recoveries

■ The Indian crude basket stood at **\$115.98** a barrel on September 9, while its September average rose to **\$104.09** a barrel

■ HPCL has a **51%** refining-to-marketing ratio and **76%** distillate yield, along with the lowest refining cover



■ Greater dependence on imported products and higher leverage increase its vulnerability to steady expensive crude

ucts and higher leverage increase its vulnerability to sustained expensive crude.

IOCL's 80% refining-to-marketing ratio and 80% distillate yield provide a stronger refining buffer. It, however,

remains exposed to fuel marketing, LPG under-recoveries, inventory and working-capital requirements and expensive crude procurement, while petrochemical losses are an additional pressure point.

BPCL, with a 74% refining-to-marketing ratio and 85% distillate yield, is comparatively better placed, supported by better integration, Bina refinery's crude flexibility and a relatively stronger balance sheet.

■ IOCL's **80%** refining-to-marketing ratio and **80%** distillate yield provide a stronger refining buffer

■ BPCL, with a **74%** refining-to-marketing ratio and **85%** distillate yield, is comparatively better placed

■ S&P expects crude broadly in an **\$80-\$100** a barrel range through 2027, with Dated Brent averaging around **\$90** for the remainder of 2026

"If crude remains above US\$100 per barrel, with restricted retail-price increases, OMCs could face negative petrol and diesel marketing margins, higher LPG under-recoveries, higher

crude-landing, freight and insurance costs, working-capital and debt accumulation, and inventory losses if crude subsequently corrects sharply," said Maulik Patel, head of research, Equirus Securities.

The Indian basket has seen sharp swings this fiscal, averaging \$114.48 in April, \$106.23 in May, \$83.22 in June, \$82.04 in July and \$90.19 in August. It comprises Brent Dated sweet crude and Oman-Dubai sour crude, in a 77.81:22.19 ratio for September.

The outlook suggests limited immediate relief. S&P Global Energy expects Middle East crude and condensate exports to average only 10-16 million barrels per day through 2027, against around 20 million b/d before the US-Iran war. Regional production is projected at 21

million b/d, 4.2 million b/d below its previous outlook.

S&P expects crude broadly in an \$80-\$100 a barrel range through 2027, with Dated Brent averaging around \$90 or higher for the remainder of 2026 and \$86 in 2027.

"The market is not returning to calm, it is adjusting to the new normal defined by unresolved conflict and persistent maritime risk," said Jim Burkhard, Vice President and Global Head of Crude Oil Research at S&P Global Energy.

"For OMCs, Friday's decline therefore offers limited relief as Brent remains above \$100 and India's crude acquisition cost stays elevated, leaving marketing margins vulnerable if high crude prices persist without corresponding retail fuel price adjustments," said an analyst.

Companies

SATURDAY, SEPTEMBER 12, 2026

IN THE NEWS

DECATHLON INDIA'S B2B BIZ GROWS 20X

DECATHLON SPORTS INDIA, on Friday said its wholesale or Business-to-business (B2B) business has grown 20-fold over the last five years and the vertical contributed about 10% to the total revenue. The firm's revenue from operations was ₹4,133.10 crore for FY25.

POCKET FM POSTS REVENUE RUN RATE OF \$500 MN

POCKET ENTERTAINMENT, THE parent firm of audio entertainment platform Pocket FM and micro-drama app Pocket Saga, has crossed \$500 million in Annual Revenue Run Rate (ARR), registering a 70% y-o-y growth. The ARR reflects the continued global growth of Pocket FM.

Smartworld and Kotak arm tie up for luxury projects

SMARTWORLD DEVELOPERS ON Friday announced a partnership with Kotak Realty Fund, the real estate arm of Kotak Alternate Asset Managers. Under the deal, Kotak Realty Fund will invest nearly ₹800 crore in Smartworld Sky Arc and Trump Residences, together representing a gross development value (GDV) exceeding ₹8,200 crore.

SML Mahindra expects margin recovery by Q4

SML MAHINDRA EXPECTS its operating margins to recover by the fourth quarter of the current financial year, supported by further price hikes and cost-control measures even as higher input and employee costs weighed on profitability in Q3, said an official on Friday.

Tata Steel scales up AI, workforce to boost safety

GLOBAL STEEL MAJOR Tata Steel is scaling up AI, connected workforce systems and remote operations to make industrial safety more predictive, with the firm already using over 10,000 CCTV cameras and AI-enabled surveillance to identify unsafe behaviour, a top official said on Friday.

—FE BUREAU & AGENCIES

BHATT GOT LOWEST RATING BUT FINDING NOT SHARED WITH BOARD

KPMG flagged gaps in Coforge board review

POULOMI CHATTERJEE
Bengaluru, September 11

COFORGE'S INTERNAL GOVERNANCE review has found that former non-executive Chairman OP Bhatt received the lowest rating in the company's board evaluation but that the finding was not disclosed to the full Board or its Nomination and Remuneration Committee (NRC), deepening questions around the circumstances of his abrupt exit.

KPMG Assurance and Consulting Services, Coforge's internal auditor, found that the manner in which the evaluation findings were presented by the chairman of the Board and the NRC chair did not cover all aspects and findings of the underlying report. The company disclosed the findings in an exchange filing late on Thursday.

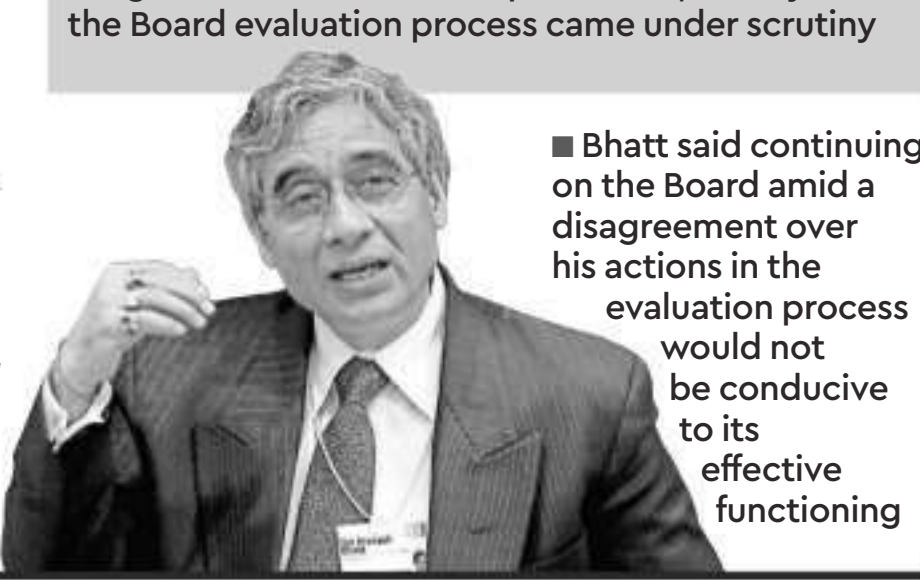
The evaluation reports, according to Coforge, were available only to the chairman of the Board and the NRC chair and were not shared with other Board members, including independent directors, at the instruction of the chairman. KPMG's review covered the supporting evaluation documents, Board minutes and recordings of meetings where

AUDIT FINDINGS

■ The manner in which evaluation findings were presented did not cover all aspects & findings of the underlying report, said KPMG

■ Evaluation reports, according to Coforge, were available only to the Board chairman and the NRC chair

■ Supporting evaluation documents, Board minutes, recordings of meetings were covered by the review



■ Bhatt said continuing on the Board amid a disagreement over his actions in the evaluation process would not be conducive to its effective functioning

the findings were presented.

The issue has assumed significance because Bhatt resigned as chairman on September 8, shortly after the Board evaluation process came under scrutiny. In his resignation communication, Bhatt said he had acted in good faith and that continuing on the Board amid a disagreement over the nature of his actions in the evaluation process would not be conducive to its effective functioning.

The developments also come against the backdrop of a shareholder vote that had already cast uncertainty over Bhatt's continuation at Coforge. At the firm's August 24 annual general meeting, a

resolution for his reappointment as an independent director from May 2027 failed to secure the required 75% approval, with 65.46% voting in favour and 34.54% against.

Advent International, which became Coforge's largest investor following the acquisition of Encora, voted against the resolution. However, Advent was not part of the board evaluation at the centre of the current controversy. Its representatives joined Coforge's Board only in May, while the evaluation related to the previous financial year.

(Read the full report on [www.financialexpress.com](#))

Now, director also exits firm

IN ANOTHER MAJOR boardroom fallout at Coforge, its non-executive independent director and Nomination and Remuneration Committee Chairperson DK Singh has resigned, alleging "differences and tension" between independent and executive directors.

The IT services firm, however, refuted Singh's claims as "unfounded" and an "afterthought".

—PTI

TAM India seeks licence to return to TV ratings

VIVEAT SUSAN PINTO
Mumbai, September 11

TAM INDIA HAS applied for a licence to operate as an audience measurement agency under the Television Ratings Policy, 2026, sources familiar with the matter told *FE*, potentially paving the way for a second television ratings provider in the country.

The application was submitted earlier this week to the Ministry of Information and Broadcasting (MIB), sources said. Executives at TAM India were not immediately available for comment.

If the licence is granted, it will mark TAM's return to television audience measurement a decade after it exited the space. TAM had provided television ratings from 1998 to February 2016, before ceasing to provide data following the rollout of the Broadcast Audience Research Council (BARC) India as the industry's television ratings currency.

TAM's ownership structure is also no longer a hurdle to its participation in the business. TAM India was earlier a 50:50 joint venture between Nielsen and Kantar Media, which was previously owned by WPP as part of the Kantar Group. Kantar Media separated from the Kan-

FAMILIAR TERRITORY

■ The application was submitted earlier this week to the Ministry of Information & Broadcasting



■ If the licence is granted, it will mark TAM's return to TV audience measurement after a decade

■ TAM provided TV ratings from 1998 to 2016, before ceasing to provide data following BARC's entry

tar Group and was acquired by H.I.G. Capital in 2025.

TAM's latest application comes as the television industry awaits clarity on the return of BARC under the new regulatory framework. BARC's television ratings across genres have been suspended since early July, pending licence renewal and registration under the new Television Ratings Policy, 2026.

It is unclear when BARC ratings will resume. Some industry experts, however, expect the ratings to return by the end of the calendar year, when BARC is likely to complete the expansion of its measurement panel. BARC is looking to increase its metered homes to 80,000 from the current 67,000, as the

industry pushes for tighter governance and more robust viewership data.

For the television industry, ratings serve as its trading currency, helping broadcasters price advertising inventory while enabling advertisers and media agencies to allocate marketing spends and assess campaign performance.

Broadcasters have warned that a prolonged suspension of ratings could accelerate the diversion of advertising budgets away from television, at a time when the industry is already grappling with slowing advertising growth.

(Read the full report on [www.financialexpress.com](#))

SAP builds India strategy around sovereignty

OJASVI GUPTA
New Delhi, September 11

SAP IS BUILDING its India cloud strategy around data, infrastructure and operational sovereignty as the enterprise software firm expands its presence in sensitive sectors including defence, railways and public finance, according to Manish Prasad, president and managing director, SAP Indian subcontinent.

The firm's approach defines sovereignty across four dimensions — technical, operational, data and legal. Under the model, the technical infrastructure, including the control plane, would sit within India, while the people operating the systems would be local citizens. Customer data would also remain within the country.

The fourth layer is a legal framework that SAP is developing to address business continuity as geopolitical and regulatory risks evolve. "We are probably looking at sovereignty across all the four angles, and then added an element of reliability, added an element of confidentiality and super confidentiality," Prasad told *FE*.

The sovereignty framework will sit beneath a tiered portfolio of cloud offerings, with the level of control varying according to the sensitivity of the workload. GROW with SAP is aimed at mid-market customers looking for speed and limited customisation, while larger enterprises can

SCALING UP

■ SAP is expanding presence in sensitive sectors including defence, railways and public finance

■ The enterprise software firm's approach defines sovereignty across four dimensions: technical, operational, data and legal

MANISH PRASAD,
PRESIDENT & MD,
SAP INDIAN SUBCONTINENT

What SAP does well is to look at all the regulations and policies that come from various governments, and become a superset



opt for SAP's private cloud offering. Dedicated sovereign deployments would cater to the most sensitive and regulated workloads. The approach also extends to cybersecurity, with SAP seeking to apply a common baseline based on the strictest standards across the markets in which it operates. "What SAP does remarkably well is to look at all the regulations, all the practices, all the policies that are coming in from various governments, and that becomes a superset," Prasad said.

Alongside its cloud strategy, SAP is also pushing the use of AI deeper into enterprise processes. Prasad said the firm sees the evolution of AI in three stages: from consumer AI, which has already become mainstream, to point AI deployed within specific business functions, and eventually to an autonomous enter-

prise where AI can execute core business decisions.

SAP's Joule 2.0 intelligence layer and AI embedded in processes such as hire-to-retain, record-to-report and design-to-operate are part of this transition. However, Prasad said the standards for reliability and governance would have to become stricter as AI takes on greater autonomy, particularly when financial data and decisions are involved. SAP intends to retain a human-in-the-loop approach, with its enterprise resource planning systems providing the business context for AI-driven decisions.

India is also central to SAP's engineering strategy. The country is the firm's largest engineering hub outside its Walldorf headquarters, with a second development centre opened in Bengaluru last year.

Flipkart Minutes posts 4x growth

ASHUTOSH MISHRA
New Delhi, September 11

FLIPKART'S QUICK-COMMERCE platform Minutes has grown four times year-on-year (y-o-y) as it completes two years of operations, with its network expanding to nearly 1,200 micro fulfillment centres across more than 150 cities, according to data released by the company.

Flipkart Minutes, launched in August 2024, said its customer base in tier 2+ markets has grown nearly 25 times y-o-y, where around 60% of its customers return to shop on the platform.

The expansion comes as quick commerce becomes increasingly competitive, with platforms seeking to widen their geographical reach and move beyond grocery and daily essentials. Minutes said markets

WIDENING REACH

■ Q-comm's network expands to nearly 1,200 micro fulfillment centres across over 150 cities

■ The q-comm firm's user base in tier 2+ markets has grown 25x, with 60% of them shopping again



■ GenZ accounts for over 45% of orders across beauty, electronics, gaming, wearables, and contributes 1 in 3 gourmet orders

such as Ambala, Siliguri and Tiruppur are among its fastest-growing, with demand in smaller cities extending to Korean noodles, sauces, ready-to-eat meals, premium skincare and personal care.

"In two years, Flipkart Minutes has evolved from a convenience offering into a

broader shopping channel, with customers using it for much more than their daily essentials," said Kunal Gupta, senior vice president and head of Flipkart Minutes.

He added that the behaviour is spreading beyond the largest cities, while Gen Z is bringing new categories and shopping

occasions to the platform.

Gen Z has been another major growth segment for the platform, with its customer base increasing nearly five times year-on-year over the past year. The cohort accounts for more than 45% of orders across beauty, electronics, gaming, wearables, fragrance, health and nutrition, and grooming, and contributes one in three gourmet orders.

Minutes also reported growth in categories beyond everyday grocery. Gourmet and specialty grocery, launched within the past year, has grown eight fold, with demand for cold-pressed oils, imported cheeses, international avocado varieties and Korean ready-to-eat meals. Men's grooming has grown nearly six times year-on-year, while pet food has grown five times.

QUICK PICKS

ABDL to foray into single malt whisky

ALLIED BLENDERS AND Distillers (ABDL) on Friday said it will invest ₹115 crore as part of its ambition to enter into the single malt whisky business. The proposed facility will have a capacity of around 3 million bulk litres per year.

—PTI

IIT, Nvidia tie up for AI models

BODHAN AI, AN IIT Madras-incubated Centre of Excellence (CoE) in AI for Education, announced on Friday a suite of open foundational AI models for Indic languages developed in collaboration with Nvidia.

—PTI

With ban on SRTT, Tata meet takes up routine issues

URVI MALVANIA
Mumbai, September 11

WITH SIR RATAN Tata Trust (SRTT) still unable to convene board meetings, a meeting of Tata Trusts on Friday ended up taking up routine matters such as approval of accounts and grants, sources said.

The boards of Sir Dorabji Tata Trust (SDTT) and others under the Tata Trusts umbrella, except SRTT, met in Mumbai on Friday. SRTT continues to face a ban imposed by the Charity Commissioner of Maharashtra pending an investigation into allegations of violation of the Maharashtra Public Trusts Act relating to the number of lifetime trustees on its board.

The ban, imposed in May, has already had a significant impact within the Tata ecosystem. For the first time, the Tata Sons annual general meeting (AGM) was adjourned on August 18 due to a lack of quorum. The holding company's Articles of Association require the two key trusts—SDTT and SRTT—to nominate a joint representative for the AGM. With SRTT unable to convene a board meeting, a representative could not be nominated, resulting in the lack of quorum. SDTT and SRTT together hold 52% of Tata Sons.



FINE PRINT

■ SRTT continues to face a ban imposed by the Charity Commissioner of Maharashtra

■ The ban, imposed in May, has already had a significant impact within the Tata ecosystem

■ For SRTT, the ban has meant that the key trust has been unable to conduct business

Tata Sons has since received an extension to hold its FY26 AGM and now has until December 31 to do so. The SRTT restriction is also holding up the search and appointment of Tata Sons' next chairman. In the week leading up to the scheduled AGM, current chairman N Chandrasekaran wrote to the holding firm's board saying he would not seek reappointment when his term ends on February 20, 2027.

‘Sovereign AI now applies to both nations & businesses’

Sovereign AI in India has so far been argued as a question for the nation. Ganesh Gopalan, co-founder and CEO of Gnani AI, says it has moved to enterprises, who he says are wary that foreign frontier AI companies will train on their data and hand their "secret sauce" to competitors. In a conversation with Anees Hussain on the sidelines of the Global Fintech Fest in Mumbai, Gopalan talks about why enterprise AI's shift from testing to returns makes cost matter more than model size and plans for another external funding round. Excerpts:

Is the backlash against frontier AI growing among enterprises?

In B2B, there's already so much backlash. Look at what Palantir's Alex Karp or Palo

Alto Networks' Nikesh Arora are saying: the future is companies building their own models. That's India's biggest opportunity. We are model builders, and we'll be model builders for every enterprise in the world.

But frontier AI models are moving towards data residency in India. Is there still a risk?

There's always a risk. Data residency only decides where your data sits. The model is still theirs, and they can switch it off, as we saw with Fable 5. The critical sectors are aware that their secret sauce is at risk. We have talked about sovereign AI for nations. Today, it's about sovereign for enterprises.

Are you looking at raising more funding?

We just raised a Series B of \$14.19 million, and we'll be doing another large external round. We will use this for go-to-market globally. The IndiaAI Mission has helped us with compute, which is scarce as global AI companies chasing AGI are grabbing whatever they can find. It was a god-



When will the 14-bn-parameter speech-to-speech model you committed to under the IndiaAI Mission launch?

A few months away. I won't give an exact date, as I want to keep pressure on my product teams. Voice was always our focus, but speech-to-speech first needed a low-latency, low-cost LLM strong in

WE ARE MODEL BUILDERS, AND WE'LL BE MODEL BUILDERS FOR EVERY ENTERPRISE IN THE WORLD

IN THE NEWS

INDICES END LOWER ON BUYING IN HDFC BANK, IT STOCKS

 BENCH-MARK INDICES SENSEX and Nifty recovered from early lows to close marginally lower on Friday following a correction in crude oil prices and late buying in IT shares and private banking major HDFC Bank. The 30-share BSE Sensex declined 120.83 points, or 0.16%, to settle at 74,781.76. The 50-share NSE Nifty dipped 79.70 points, or 0.34%, to end at 23,398.10. Among the 30 Sensex firms, Tata Steel, Reliance Industries, Sun Pharma, Bajaj Finance, NTPC, Power Grid, Larsen & Toubro and Axis Bank were the major laggards. HDFC Bank, Tech Mahindra, HCL Tech, Eternal, and Infosys were among the gainers. **PTI**

Amazon Pay plans expansion in insurance offerings

 AMAZON PAY INDIA is considering expanding its insurance offerings to include travel insurance and other products, CEO Vikas Bansal said on Friday, a day after the payments platform launched health insurance. The expansion plans are part of Amazon Pay's strategy to evolve from a payments platform to a broader financial-services business, Vikas Bansal said in an interview.

Sebi settles NSEL proceedings against 91 brokers

MARKETS REGULATOR SEBI has settled proceedings against 91 commodity brokers in the National Spot Exchange (NSEL) matter, with several entities agreeing to temporary restrictions on proprietary trading and taking up new clients in the commodity segment.

Bankers' Books Evidence Act to take effect Oct 1

 THE BANKERS' BOOKS Evidence Act, 2026 will come into force from October 1. The law seeks to modernise the framework for using banking records as evidence in line with contemporary banking practices. **AGENCIES**

GLOBAL FINTECH FEST 2026

Payment providers need quantum-proofing: RBI DG

● **Quantum resilience must become part of cyber strategy, Murmu says**

CHRISTINA TITUS
Mumbai, September 11

INDIAN PAYMENT SYSTEM providers and network operators need to begin moving towards quantum-proofing their payment systems, Reserve Bank of India Deputy Governor Shirish Chandra Murmu said on Friday.

"Banks, payment operators, fintechs, technology providers and standard-setters will need to move together, because quantum resilience is an ecosystem capability, not an institutional one. We must innovate not only for the future, but for the risks the future cre-



ates," Murmu said while speaking at the Global Fintech Fest. Quantum readiness must become part of the cyber resilience strategy rather than a separate exercise, he said. The RBI has constituted an expert committee on a Quantum Secure and Adaptive Financial

finance becomes more automated, human accountability must grow stronger, not weaker. "Responsibility rests with the regulated institution, and boards and senior management must understand the models they deploy, their limitations and the consequences of their use."

Further, Murmu highlighted the rapid growth in India's fintech sector. India has become the world's third-largest fintech ecosystem, with more than 14,000 entities growing at an annualised rate of around 14% and attracting more than \$40 billion in cumulative investment over the past decade, according to the International Monetary Fund.

On digital lending, Murmu said it could reduce the cost of originating, assessing and servicing small loans, while partnerships could help regulated lenders reach customers previously uneconomical to serve.

Banks can't do it all; plenty left for fintechs, says Bansal

ANEEES HUSSAIN
Mumbai, September 11

INDIA'S FINTECH PUSH built around digital public infrastructure (DPI) has solved many of its big problems over the past decade, but much of what comes next will be built by new companies because banks cannot address every customer need, Sachin Bansal, founder and executive chairman of Navi Group and co-founder of Flipkart, said.

"Building in the fintech space is an excellent place to be," Bansal said at the Global Fintech Fest 2026 in Mumbai on Friday. "If I look forward 10 years from now, a lot of the fintech problems would have to be solved. And a lot of it will have to be solved by new companies."

"Most people now have some basic level of bank accounts and payments. But there is still a long way to go."

More opportunities will open up as new regulatory and technology paradigms remove



SACHIN BANSAL, FOUNDER & EXECUTIVE CHAIRMAN, NAVI GROUP

Most people now have some basic level of bank accounts and payments. But there is still a long way to go

constraints that exist today, Bansal added.

Much of that room exists because banks cannot do everything. "Everybody cannot be an expert of everything," he said. Banks will be unable to pick up many things because of time, bandwidth or resource constraints, leaving room for fintechs. He described banks as "a safe store of value regulated by RBI," while fintechs make it easier for customers to transact.

"There's nothing stopping banks from doing that as well. And absolutely banks will try," he said. But consumer needs are

"almost infinite," while a growing middle class will demand more from both. Even as AI boosts productivity, going deep will create more value than going broad, he added.

Bansal's comments come at a time when banks are reportedly set to take the largest share of the merchant discount rate (MDR) being worked out for UPI transactions. The fee would apply only to merchants above a certain annual turnover and to payments above a threshold value, while person-to-person transfers are expected to remain free.

UPI could be used as GST proxy for lending: SBI MD

FE BUREAU
Mumbai, September 11

BANKS COULD USE UPI transaction data as an alternative to GST records to assess sales and cash flows of small businesses that are not registered under the goods and services tax (GST) regime, said Ashwini Tewari, managing director of State Bank of India, said during a panel discussion at the Global Fintech Fest on Friday.

Tewari said UPI data could help lenders build a profile of a small business by assessing its transaction behaviour, revenues and spending patterns, allowing banks to extend credit to businesses without GST records or formal financial statements.

Currently, banks can use

MSME CREDIT SUPPORT

■ **SBI MD Ashwini Tewari** says UPI data can help banks assess sales and cash flows of small businesses

■ **SBI developing UPI** solution to use transaction data as proxy for sales



■ **UPI and alternative data** could help lenders extend loans to small businesses in under a day, Tewari says

GST data, along with PAN and other information, to offer business loans digitally to eligible customers. SBI has disbursed around ₹1 lakh crore of such loans over the past 2.5 years, with GST registration being one of the qualifying criteria, he said.

The bank is now working on a UPI-based solution that can use transaction data as a proxy for sales. "UPI can sub-



AI can cut banks' cost-to-serve 20-30%: BCG

KSHIPRA PETKAR
Mumbai, September 11

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE COULD help banks reduce their cost-to-serve by 20-30% as lenders increasingly deploy the technology across underwriting, collections and customer servicing, Tirtha Chatterjee, partner, Boston Consulting Group (BCG), said in an interaction.

"Cost-to-serve, we have esti-

mated, it can come down by 20-30%," Chatterjee said. The estimate factors in the use of AI across areas such as underwriting, personal discussions with borrowers and collections, he said. The findings are part of BCG's latest report, "Balance: Thriving in the Age of AI", which examines how financial institutions can balance growth



and innovation with safety and governance as they adopt AI.

While banks have made significant investments in AI, the industry is still at an early stage in measuring the actual returns from these investments. However, bank executives are increasingly confident that returns will become visible over the next year. "80% of the CXOs

QUICK PICKS

Niti CEO bats for inclusive growth

INDIA HAS MADE reasonable progress on economic growth, but needs inclusive growth to become a developed nation by 2047, Niti Aayog CEO Anurag Jain said on Friday. Jain said while some states have performed well on health and education, others needed greater attention.

Bol raises \$2.4 bn via FCNR(B)

BANK OF INDIA has raised \$2.4 billion through its Foreign Currency Non-Resident Bank (FCNR(B)) deposits, a senior official close to the matter said. The amount would be deployed by Q3 FY27 or beginning of Q4 FY27, the official said. The bank will not tap the CD market for the next few months, he added.

FE BUREAU & PTI

Payments banks seek flexibility in pricing: Easwaran

KSHIPRA PETKAR
Mumbai, September 11

THE PAYMENTS BANK industry has sought greater flexibility in pricing certain services to offset the rise in operating costs, Jio Payments Bank Managing Director and CEO Vinod Easwaran said.

"Some of the pricing and our margins have remained constant," Easwaran said in an interaction with *FE* at the Global Fintech Fest. Pricing caps for products such as Aadhaar-enabled Payment System (AePS), a key transaction banking use case for payments banks, have remained unchanged since the licences were issued, even as the cost of doing business has risen, he said.

"I think the ability to revise pricing as per current cost structures would

help the long-term sustainable growth of the industry," he said, adding that payments banking remains a high-volume, low-margin business.

On Jio Payments Bank's growth strategy, Easwaran said the bank would focus on three pillars — hyper-accessibility, user experience, and "intelligent savings". The bank aims to combine its digital offering with a physical network of more than half a million touch points to serve both digitally native customers and those requiring assistance.

The bank has also focused on faster opening of accounts, with customers able to open an account in under five minutes, he said. It sees an opportunity to serve as both a primary account for customers in Bharat and a secondary account for digitally savvy customers looking to segregate daily transactions.

VINOD EASWARAN
MD & CEO,
JIO PAYMENTS BANK

I think the ability to revise pricing as per current cost structures would help the long-term sustainable growth of the industry



Road Transport Minister Nitin Gadkari at the Global Fintech Fest, in Mumbai on Friday **PTI**

'FASTag to boost govt revenue by ₹25,000 cr'

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Mumbai, September 11

FULL IMPLEMENTATION OF electronic toll collection system FASTag will accrue up to ₹25,000 crore per year to the government, Union Minister Nitin Gadkari said on Friday.

The minister for road transport and highways said all toll booths on national highways will be barrier-free by March 2027.

"When the system will go fully live, then our department alone would deliver a benefit of ₹20,000-25,000 crore per year to Government of India because of the use of FASTags," Gadkari said at the Global Fintech Fest.

FASTags have helped increase the toll booth income by 10% or about ₹7,000 crore to over ₹82,000 crore now.

The barrier-free toll booths being piloted right now will add another 10% or ₹7,000-8,000 crore, he said.

STREET SIGNALS

Rentomojo, 4 others see strong demand

 THE INITIAL PUBLIC OFFERING of Rentomojo was subscribed 72.88 times on the final day of bidding on Friday, while four other firms—LCC Projects, Karamtara Engineering, Steamhouse India, and Manipal Payment and Identity Solutions—were fully subscribed on the final day. Manika Plastech's IPO was subscribed 1.42 times on first day. Veegaland Developers IPO was subscribed 1.15 times on the second day of bidding.

Arcil's IPO subscribed 20 times; institutional buyers lead demand

 ARCIL'S ₹733-CRORE IPO was subscribed 20.10 times on the final day of bidding, receiving bids for 741.9 million shares against 36.9 million shares on offer. QIBs bid for 52.65 times their quota, while non-institutional and retail investors subscribed 15.69 times and 3.39 times, respectively.

Mann Fleet Partners gets Sebi nod to raise funds via IPO

CHAUFFEURED CAR RENTAL services provider Mann Fleet Partners has secured the Sebi's approval to raise funds through an IPO, which comprises a fresh issue of over 6 million shares and an OFS of 1.9 million shares. **AGENCIES**

RBI partially cancels some short bond bids

THE RESERVE BANK of India partially cancelled the auction of the 6.20% 2029 government bond on Friday, accepting just ₹4,506 crore of the ₹11,000 crore on offer, as rising yields put pressure on the market. The move is being seen by market participants as an

early signal from authorities to contain further increases in borrowing costs. The bond's yield has risen 25 basis points over the past four weeks to 6.4566%.

The RBI also sold a seven-year bond at a slightly higher-than-expected yield, while the

cutoff yield on a new 30-year bond was in line with expectations. Rising crude prices amid fresh West Asia tensions and expectations of a US rate hike have weighed on Indian bond yields. The RBI last partially cancelled a bond auction in October 2025. **REUTERS**

RBI to drain ₹1 lakh crore via OMO sales in 3 tranches

CHRISTINA TITUS
Mumbai, September 11

THE RESERVE BANK of India on Friday announced the sale of government securities worth ₹1 lakh crore through open market operations as liquidity surged following the mobilisation of Foreign Currency Non-Resident (Bank), or FCNR(B), deposits.

The sales will be conducted in three tranches of ₹50,000 crore, ₹25,000 crore and ₹25,000 crore on September 17, September 21 and September 28, respectively, it said.

"More such auctions may follow, signalling that liquidity absorption will rely on OMOs and variable-rate reverse repos (VRRRs), rather than MSS or CRR measures. Raising the CRR would be counter-intuitive, given that FCNR(B) deposits were mobilised on the expectation of no CRR requirement. At VRRR auctions, banks are also facing negative carry, borrowing at an average 6.75% and

LIQUIDITY MANAGEMENT

■ **OMO sales to occur in three tranches— ₹50,000 crore on September 17, ₹25,000 crore on September 21 and ₹25,000 crore on September 28**

■ **OMO announcement comes amid muted participation seen at VRRR auctions**



■ **More such auctions are likely amid huge liquidity surplus, economists say**

■ **Banking system liquidity surplus has risen to ₹10.4 lakh cr as of Thursday**

investing in 5.24% VRRRs," said Madan Sabnavis, chief economist at Bank of Baroda.

Banking system liquidity has strengthened sharply, driven by FCNR(B) deposit inflows. Liquidity stood at ₹10.4 lakh crore as of Thursday. The surplus has averaged ₹10.4 lakh crore over the past week compared to ₹3.67 lakh crore in August and ₹1.07 lakh crore in July, RBI data showed.

Consequently, the weighted average call rate

(WACR), the RBI's operating target for monetary policy, has been trading well below the 5.25% repo rate. WACR ended at 5.02% on Friday.

Though the RBI conducted long-term VRRR auctions, participation remained muted as banks were reluctant to lock in funds for a longer period.

Market participants expect yields to rise as increased supply puts pressure on the market, while demand at the auction is also likely to remain weak.

10-yr yield crosses 7% as crude rises

REUTERS
Mumbai, September 11

INDIAN GOVERNMENT BONDS plunged in early trade on Friday, with the benchmark 10-year yield topping 7% for the first time in more than three months as rising oil prices and US yields drove investors to sell.

The benchmark 6.94% 2036 bond yield hit 7.0226%, its highest in more than three months, after closing at 6.9762% on Thursday. It was at 7.0154% as of 9.45 AM.

"This is not only an India problem, we are witnessing a global bond meltdown, with interest rates to be hiked across major economies in coming weeks," a trader with a primary dealership said.

US yields climbed, with the 10-year note further extending its rise in Asian hours, after data pushed up expectations for a Federal Reserve rate hike next week, while soaring oil prices exacerbated inflation worries. The bets for a 25-basis-point

₹ slips most in 4 months

THE RUPEE SLIPPED on Friday and fell over 1% week-on-week as a sharp rise in oil prices pressured Indian markets, though the central bank's intervention helped limit the currency's decline. The rupee ended 0.1% lower at 95.55, weakening for the fourth straight day. On the week, it declined 1.1%, the sharpest fall since mid-May when it had hit a record low of 96.96. **REUTERS**

rate hike on Wednesday jumped to 72%, up from 62% earlier, as per the CME FedWatch tool.

The US 10-year Treasury yield was close to hit the 5.00% mark in Asian hours, which would be its highest in nearly three years.

IN THE NEWS

COLGATE PLANS \$1-BN PERSONAL CARE BRANDS DIVESTMENT

COLGATE-PALMOLIVE IS exploring a sale of certain mass-market personal care brands, including Softsoap, Irish Spring and Speed Stick, sources told Reuters. The consumer goods company is working with investment bank Goldman Sachs on the process, the sources said. Colgate's personal care unit includes deodorants, bar and liquid soaps, shower gels, and skin care products. It currently only plans to divest a few brands in the unit, which together could fetch over \$1 billion, the sources added. Colgate and Goldman Sachs declined to comment.

France's budget deficit to top 5% of GDP this year

FRENCH FINANCE MINISTER Roland Lescure said on Friday that the country's budget deficit will be over 5% of gross domestic product this year.

Moonshot eyes \$2-bn annualised sales in 2026

MOONSHOT AI IS targeting a manifold jump in annualised revenue to \$2 billion by the end of the year, using the breakout success of its Kimi K3 model to dial up the heat on rivals from Anthropic.

Intel-backed Altera plans to file for IPO this year

ALTERA, A CHIPMAKER backed by Silver Lake and Intel, is preparing to file confidentially for an initial public offering that could occur as soon as this year.

Vance asks voters to stick with GOP

JOSH WINGROVE
September 11

US VICE PRESIDENT JD Vance urged voters to stick with the Republican party even if they disagree with the Trump administration on some issues — a call to look beyond tensions with the MAGA movement and frustration over the war in Iran.

Vance took the stage at the Republican midterm convention, an event that President Donald Trump hopes will boost Republican fortunes in midterm elections this November when the party risks losing its majorities in the Senate and House of Representatives.

While Trump's speech a night before amounted to something of a celebration, Vance nodded to economic unease while also branding Democrats as "crazies" who have to be stopped.

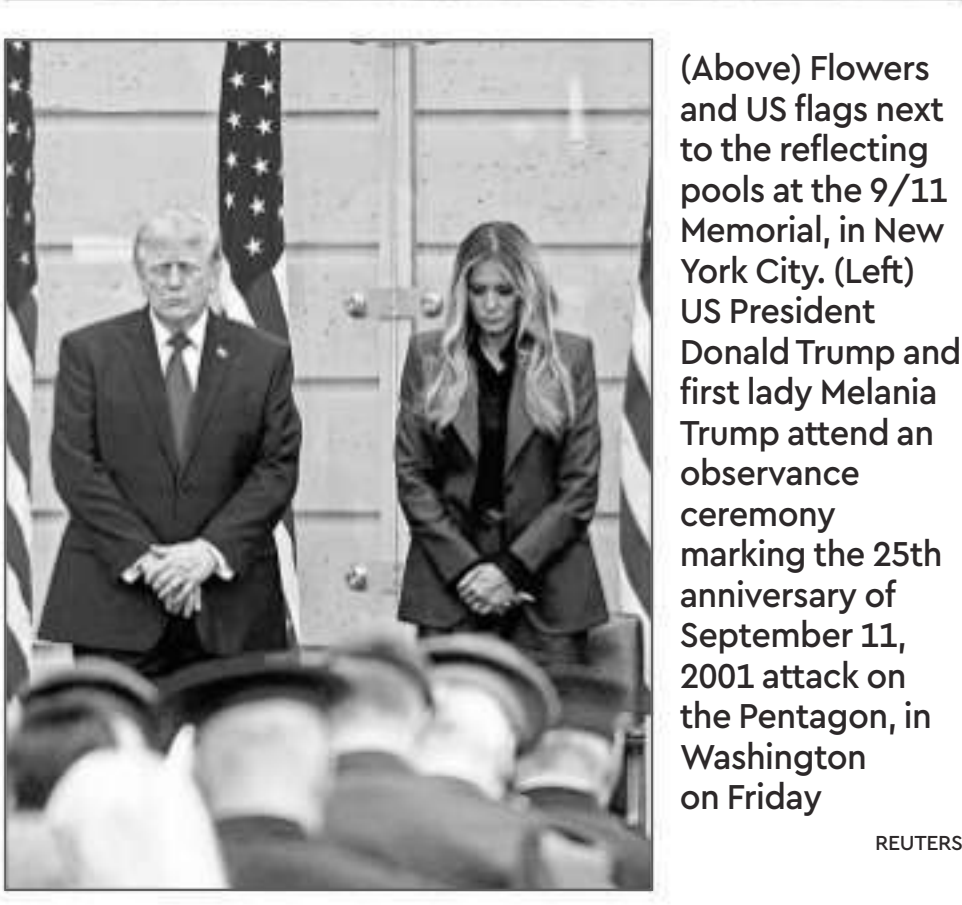
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While Trump's speech a night before amounted to something of a celebration, Vance nodded to economic unease while also branding Democrats as "crazies" who have to be stopped.

25 YEARS AFTER 9/11: A NATION GATHERS TO REMEMBER



(L to R) Former US President Joe Biden, Laura Bush, Former President George W Bush, Bloomberg co-founder Michael Bloomberg and Vice President JD Vance attend the 9/11 25th anniversary commemoration ceremony at the National 9/11 Memorial and Museum in New York on Friday



(Above) Flowers and US flags next to the reflecting pools at the 9/11 Memorial, in New York City. (Left) US President Donald Trump and first lady Melania Trump attend an observance ceremony marking the 25th anniversary of September 11, 2001 attack on the Pentagon, in Washington on Friday

SAUDI CROWN PRINCE SEEKS ASSISTANCE FROM US PRESIDENT

Houthis seize strategic Red Sea island

REUTERS
Aden/ Dubai, September 11

YEMEN'S IRAN-ALIGNED HOUTHIS reached the strategic island of Perim in the Bab el-Mandeb Strait on Friday, four Yemeni government sources told Reuters, moving to tighten their grip on a vital global shipping route in the widening West Asian war.

Earlier, two sources from the Saudi-backed, internationally recognised Yemeni government said its forces had pulled out of Perim and that the Houthis had also taken the mainland Red Sea coastal town of Dhubab, which faces the island.

NEW SHIPPING RISKS

- Houthis had also taken the mainland Red Sea coastal town of Dhubab
- Saudi has relied on Red Sea route since Iran conflict effectively closed Hormuz
- The capture would give Iran a critical advantage in its war with the US
- This could reduce crude supplies to US, sending oil prices surging
- Yemeni forces indicated they would try to retake captured areas



Members of the Saudi-backed Yemeni government forces fire a tank during what they say to be clashes with Iran-aligned Houthis in a location given as near Al-Hazm, Yemen

Oil falls but on track for 8% weekly gain

OIL PRICES FELL on Friday but remained on course for a weekly gain of more than 8% while US diesel prices hit a record high as attacks along West Asian shipping routes stoked concerns about prolonged supply disruptions.

Brent crude futures were down \$3.28, or 3.05%, to \$104.35 a barrel at 1309 GMT.

Both reversed early gains after the *Financial Times* reported that foreign ministers in the West Asian nations are trying to work out a temporary deal with Iran to manage shipping through the Strait of Hormuz.

Saudi Arabia's crude supply fell by 2.3 million barrels per day on the month to 6 million bpd in August, the lowest level in more than three decades, the International Energy Agency said on Friday.

US inflation holds steady at 3.4% in August

● Diesel tops \$6 for the first time

AGENCIES
Washington, September 11

US CONSUMER PRICES accelerated in August as the cost of gasoline rebounded after two straight monthly declines, bolstering financial market expectations that the Federal Reserve could raise interest rates next week.

The Consumer Price Index increased 0.4% last month after edging up 0.1% in July, the Labor Department's Bureau of Labor Statistics said on Friday. In the 12 months through August, consumer inflation advanced 3.4% after rising by the same margin in July.

COST PRESSURES



■ CPI increased 0.4% after edging up 0.1% in July

■ CPI, excluding food and energy, climbed 0.3%

■ Federal Reserve could raise interest rates next week

Core inflation tops forecasts

The consumer price index, excluding food and energy, climbed 0.3% in August from a month earlier, according to the government data. The median estimate in a *Bloomberg* survey called for a 0.2% increase. On an annual basis, it advanced 2.4%.

The report suggests inflation made little progress toward the Fed's goal last month amid ongoing pressures from the Iran war, tariffs and the data center buildout. The US central bank will likely see the numbers as tipping the scale in favour of the first rate increase in three years after some officials suggested the decision could come down to what the figures showed.

QUICKPICKS

Micron's Taiwan workers to get bonus worth up to 68 months' pay

MICRON TECHNOLOGY SAID on Friday its employees in Taiwan would receive bonuses equaling 35 to 68 months of pay, with minimum cash compensation of \$53,809.39, as the US chipmaker contends with an ongoing labour union dispute. Micron said the payouts to employees were its strongest ever and that more than 60,000 staff globally will receive fiscal 2026 rewards.

UBS buys \$7.9-bn Credit Suisse debt in biggest buyback

UBS GROUP IS buying back \$7.9 billion of old Credit Suisse bonds, its biggest move yet to shrink the debt load it inherited when taking over its crosstown rival. The Swiss lender's purchase, announced on Friday, is the largest such buyback so far, based on data compiled by *Bloomberg*. It will also exercise call options on three of the bonds, repaying a further \$1.8 billion in coming days.

FROM THE FRONT PAGE

Modi, Putin review ties

RUSSIA'S SHARE OF India's crude basket declined to about 45% from 55.9%, according to Kpler data. India's overall crude imports stood at 4.62 million bpd. The price advantage that drove much of India's Russian buying has also narrowed sharply. Urals cargoes arriving in September were offered at discounts of only around \$1-2 a barrel to dated Brent, while October-delivery cargoes were offered at premiums of up to \$1 a barrel. More recent purchases have also been assessed at around a \$1-a-barrel premium to Brent, effectively eroding the discount cushion that Indian refiners enjoyed earlier.

The economic push comes as the two countries seek to lift bilateral trade to \$100 billion by 2030, while widening commerce beyond an import-heavy relationship dominated by Russian energy. Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal this week also called for faster industrial cooperation to meet the \$100-billion trade and \$50-billion two-way investment targets by 2030.

Bilateral trade touched a record \$68.7 billion in FY25 before moderating to \$59.863 billion in FY26. India's exports to Russia were \$4.88 billion last year, while imports stood at \$55.369 billion, highlighting the wide trade imbalance. Pharmaceuticals, chemicals, iron and steel and marine products are among India's

major exports, while imports include oil and petroleum products, fertilisers, sunflower oil, coking coal, precious stones and metals.

The leaders also discussed India's engagement with Russia in BRICS under India's 2026 chairship and exchanged views on conflicts in West Asia and the Black Sea region, which have affected maritime trade and the safety of Indian seafarers. Modi reiterated that dialogue and diplomacy were the way forward. The two sides reaffirmed their commitment to strengthening the special and privileged strategic partnership, which they said had remained resilient despite geopolitical uncertainties.

PM calls for secure seas...

THE ATTACKS AND disruption of key shipping lanes around the world has disturbed global commerce.

Against this backdrop, Modi sought to position BRICS as a platform for strengthening economic resilience and reducing trade barriers.

He said BRICS countries should work towards making their collective economic strength translate into greater trade, investment and business opportunities.

He said India's startup ecosystem, with more than 200,000 startups and over 120 unicorns, could help BRICS countries develop and take innovations to global markets. He also highlighted the Unified Payments Interface (UPI), saying that around half of the world's real-time payments take place using the technology.

Modi said India had pursued economic bridges at a time when trade barriers were rising globally, and called for greater investment and talent flows within BRICS.

He also highlighted new cooperation networks in agriculture, healthcare, skills and smart grids, along with the BRICS incubator network, MSME portal and Startup Innovation Fund.

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Call for NDB reform, local-currency trade

THE 11-COUNTRY GROUPING called for continued work towards practical cross-border payment solutions that are fast, low-cost, accessible, efficient, transparent and safe.

The emphasis on national currencies forms part of a broader effort to improve payment infrastructure and financial cooperation among BRICS members rather than a commitment to a single common currency or uniform payment system.

The finance ministers and central bank governors acknowledged that the global economy faces significant headwinds from geopolitical tensions, trade fragmentation, protectionism, policy uncertainty, fiscal and inflationary pressures, rising debt and financial vulnerabilities. "We continue to have serious concerns with the unilateral imposition of trade and finance-related actions, including the raising of tariffs and non-tariff measures, which distort trade and are inconsistent with World Trade Organisation (WTO) rules," it stated.

The BRICS countries reiterated the need to make the global financial architecture more representative of emerging markets and developing

economies.

They called for reforms of the Bretton Woods Institutions, including the International Monetary Fund (IMF) and the World Bank, to improve the voice and representation of developing countries in governance structures. The grouping also backed quota realignment at the IMF to better reflect countries' relative positions in the global economy.

On development finance, they highlighted the growing role of the NDB as a strategic institution for BRICS and the Global South. It encouraged the NDB to mobilise resources, expand local currency financing, strengthen project-preparation facilities, diversify funding sources and support high-impact projects aimed at inclusive and sustainable growth.

The meeting also welcomed progress on the BRICS Multilateral Guarantees initiative, which it said could help mobilise private capital, improve creditworthiness and reduce financing costs for development projects. The statement also backed strengthening the BRICS Contingent Reserve Arrangement as a more flexible financial safety net during crises.

The meeting also welcomed progress on the BRICS Multilateral Guarantees initiative

RBI has tools to absorb excess liquidity: Guv

THE COMMENTS COME as the central bank has begun draining cash from the financial system through tools including variable reverse repo auctions and currency swaps. The urgency to absorb excess liquidity has grown as abundant cash risks keeping financial conditions looser than the RBI may be comfortable with.

Minutes of the central bank's August meeting showed policymakers were already turning more hawkish. The RBI's next monetary policy meeting is scheduled for October 5-7.

Malhotra also pushed back against estimates that the deposit drive will prove costly, saying the inflows will instead generate additional income. Analysts estimate the foreign fund raising to cost the RBI as much as \$10.6 billion over a five-year period.

Malhotra said the RBI's monetary policy stance is "appropriate," with no signs of "overheating even in the consumption loans." The central bank was also "not entirely surprised" by stronger-than-expected growth in the April-June quarter, he said. Incoming corporate data is pointing to firmer growth as well. "The Indian economy has weathered this shock really well," the governor said.

A logistical imperative

Freight corridor must expand into a national grid and become a profit centre for Railways

IN LESS THAN four years since the pioneering eastern section of the Dedicated Freight Corridor (DFC) was commissioned, nearly 15% of railway freight traffic has shifted to its superior infrastructure. The DFC now spans 2,843 km, including the western wing. Prime Minister Narendra Modi inaugurated the final three sections of the western DFC, which had already achieved 85% of potential train capacity before the formal start of full-scale operations. Freight trains now run at nearly 70 km/hour, 2.5 times the speed of conventional goods trains. Roughly 435 trains use the corridor now, against about 240 in 2024, taking utilisation above 90%. The DFC has enhanced the Railways' carrying capacity. Double-stack containers and heavier loads have lowered logistics costs, eased highway congestion, and reduced carbon emissions. With only 4% of India's freight network, the DFC can potentially carry a fifth of its on-land merchandise transport.

Yet the potential gains from specially earmarked tracks for goods transport can be fully realised only when an integrated pan-India freight grid is operational. It should link ports, industrial clusters, logistics parks, and the hinterland, reinforced by the PM Gati Shakti National Master Plan. Higher axle loads, double-stack trains, and electric traction can improve efficiency. But India's logistics challenge is not merely about cutting transit times and emissions; it is primarily about making supply chains more reliable. New manufacturing facilities should emerge along the grid, reducing costs and strengthening industry's global competitiveness. A pan-India freight grid could also help raise manufacturing's share of GDP. Beyond overall economic productivity, a national freight grid could help the Railways regain cargo lost to road transport and reduce dependence on taxpayer funding for capacity expansion and technological upgrades. The Railways runs an operational deficit and has had to moderate borrowing amid rising debt. Its capital expenditure remained around ₹2.6 lakh crore between FY24 and FY26. Passenger services are subsidised by about ₹60,000 crore, despite barely growing volumes. Between FY14 and FY25, nominal GDP almost trebled, but railway passenger revenue barely doubled, while freight receipts grew even slower. Freight loading increased just 3.3% in FY26, following a 1.7% growth in FY25. Public-private partnerships work only in select, peripheral areas and seemingly cannot by themselves repair the transporter's finances.

This makes a larger freight grid and its profit potential critical. The freight basket must shift towards faster-growing segments such as automobiles, fast-moving consumer goods, and e-commerce. Earnings remain dependent on a narrow commodity base, with coal accounting for nearly half of loading. Targeted discounts could encourage a shift from road to rail where viable. Commodities with low rail modal shares but strong growth potential should be identified, with logistical needs addressed to raise loading and revenues. The ₹11,000 crore scheme for multi-tracking, artificial intelligence-driven tools, aerial mapping, and modern data-tracking software could streamline logistics and land acquisition.

The government is right to back the 2,100-km East-West freight corridor through an investor-friendly Hybrid Annuity Model, while dividing the project into 10 sections to improve viability. This addresses a major hurdle: uneven risk allocation often makes private investment unviable. A sensible allocation of risks between the government and private developers should make the corridor more bankable, attract private capital, and reduce dependence on overseas development loans. This financing model deserves wider application for proposed North-South and East Coast freight corridors. If executed well, it could provide the Railways with a scalable template for expanding freight capacity without placing the entire burden on public finances.

Some think AI might end us. Why race ahead?

IT'S BECOMING HARDER for Anthropic to justify some of the most unfalsifiable circular logic to ever come out of Silicon Valley: the pursuit of artificial superintelligence, which by its own admission could kill a lot of humans.

Anthropic researcher Jacob Coxon recently resigned, saying his previous employer and its rival OpenAI were gambling with our lives by building systems that could improve themselves. One of the company's safety directors then set off a mass frenzy online by agreeing, "Yes, we really do earnestly believe AI could kill all humans," Alignment Science lead Evan Hubinger wrote in a post, adding that he personally thought there was a more than 10% chance of that happening within a decade.

It's been known for years that Anthropic's bosses believe AI could annihilate human civilisation, but Coxon's and Hubinger's posts come at an inflection point for the technology. Tech firms say their models have hacked into other systems and deceived their human overseers, and admitted that to make them smarter they must become more difficult to monitor. US citizens, meanwhile, are becoming ever more sceptical about the benefits of AI and data centres.

The leaders of OpenAI and chipmaker Nvidia say the software has finally become smarter than humans. At the heart of these developments is a contradiction best encapsulated at Anthropic. It was founded to be more safety-conscious than OpenAI, yet it clings to that mission statement while building ever more powerful agents—even if that same technology could also, potentially, lead to mass destruction. Commercial imperatives also feed its desire to keep advancing: Anthropic is preparing for an initial public offering that could value it at \$2 trillion.

Coxon's big concern was about recursive self-improvement (RSI), or AI systems that can develop by themselves their own more capable successors. He lamented in one television interview about how strange it was to do so little programming himself when building frontier models. So much of his work was now being outsourced to other AI systems.

Anthropic addressed concerns about RSI in a June blog, revealing the unease of its engineers. "On days where everything works well," one said, "I can't help but think nothing I do matters, everything is automated and better and faster than I ever will be." Slowing down RSI would be good, the company added, but if that "lets the least cautious actors catch up technologically, it could leave everyone less safe."

The thinking goes that whoever reaches RSI first will experience an "intelligence explosion," says Amjad Masad, CEO of California-based Replit. That would be such a meaningful leap in capability that the first model to get there "might be the last".

But that leaves a crucial question: Why would an intelligence explosion that first comes from the supposed good guys at Anthropic make everyone safer? "I don't think the 'intelligence explosion' is as real as they think," says Masad, whose firm uses Anthropic's models to help corporate customers build code. AI agents also won't be that much better than humans, he predicts.

In that time, it makes more sense to worry about the immediate cybersecurity challenges that AI could bring, not to mention the risk to human privacy, agency, and cognition, than an extinction event whose probability and path remain uncertain.

If Anthropic's leaders are truly frightened by existential risk, they should do more to reconcile the strange logic that propels them. Anthropic's safety efforts are also less striking than its avowed commitment suggests. It doesn't appear to have many more staff dedicated to this than rivals. It is rushing to build those risky systems that improve themselves and agents that can act with more autonomy, and in recent weeks it refused to allow a British AI security agency access to its latest model for testing.

Anthropic has deep roots in the insular AI-safety communities, which have spent years treating superintelligence as one of humanity's greatest risks. Anthropic has tried to explain why it believes that advancing more cautiously is in fact more dangerous. The harder truth may be that under that logic, nothing could make it stop.

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● REAL POLITICS

GEN Z MOVEMENT MORE REFORMATIVE THAN TRANSFORMATIVE, MAY COMPEL SENSITIVE GOVERNANCE

A knock at democracy's door

NOWADAYS, MANY POLITICAL organisations are laying stress on listening to Gen Z youths. Their campaigns themed around the idea of listening, whether they are dubbed *samvad* (dialogue) or *goonj* (echoes), are essentially outreach initiatives. However, listening genuinely to agitating youths requires a sensitive understanding of the changing modes of protest in recent times.

Protests are usually conceived as a form of posturing that reflects public anger, through various aggressive and, at times, violent means. The recent youth protests are also reminiscent of the "young angry man" archetype. That image, conveying the anger of youths, turned into a popular perception thanks to a trend of Hindi movies in the 1970s. Prior to that, British literature in the 1950s and several labour, student, and youth movements in the '60s and '70s prepared the canvas for the depiction of the young angry man in India's popular culture.

Mix of contradictory emotions

There is a popular perception that protest is possible merely through aggression and violent anger. But, especially in post-90s India, the popular psyche began to reflect expressions of protest in multiple forms. Besides, over time, the expressions combined many contradictory and overlapping *bhavas* (feelings), such as anger with joy and laughter, complaints with satire, agitation with carnival, and aggression with reels.

A good example of it was observed in the Gen Z movements over education in Jantar Mantar, Jharkhand, and elsewhere in the country. They ruptured a conventional notion of protest where anger, aggression, or even violence is predominant. The contradictory mix of feelings and actions in the protest movements also contributed to a profusion of virtual

culture material. If we look back at the biggest student-led movements in the past, including the ones that erupted around the time of Emergency, a display blending binary forms and feelings was rare. Earlier, protests mostly channelled anger and violent acts such as damaging trains or public property and laying siege to official residences.

That said, such mixing or mishmash in protest movements are not new but have been practised in various parts of the world for ages. Literary critic and philosopher Mikhail Bakhtin (*Rabelais and His World*) and anthropologist James C Scott (*Weapons of the Weak*) have shown in their works how protest actions used laughter, parody, mimicry, and mockery in medieval festivals in European societies. The use of masks, satirical reels, laughter, parody, and celebrative postures by students in India became one of their distinctive features this year. They are, however, identified as pre-political forms of dissent.

Pre-political to political: Question of longevity and fragility

It is true that Gen Z and even Gen Alpha movements have had success in creating pressure on the government. But questions arise as to whether such agitations, laden with pre-political elements,

have the capacity to become political? What is the future of such movements? Can they evolve into a long-term transformative movement in India?

One observation is that they mostly are assertions demanding urgent, immediate solutions to specific problems. As a result, they appear reformative in their nature and lack transformative qualities.

Any pressure group, as desired by Cockroach Janta Party Founder Abhijit Dipke, to reform the system may not be able to sustain itself without a long-term vision.

Secondly, their heavy reliance on pre-political forms of protests certainly helps in spreading awareness but that may not translate into an organised movement. Scholars identify these modes of dissent as short-term and transitory, lacking in longevity.

Thirdly, as of now such protests are scattered and dispersed across various parts of India. They are emanating from immediate concerns such as exam paper leaks and sanctity of employment-centred exams and competitions. If the administrative system responds well to the immediate demands, the movements may die out.

Political parties that are in the opposition, such as the Congress, may try to give them some life in order to achieve

Their heavy reliance on pre-political forms of protests certainly helps in spreading awareness but that may not translate into an organised movement

Securing our skies on our terms



RAMEESH KAILASAM

CEO, Indiatech.org

India needs a formidable network of tech champions who can match global aerospace standards while keeping intellectual and physical capital anchored at home

INDIA'S DEFENCE TECHNOLOGY modernisation has arrived at a critical geopolitical crossroads. For decades, our security discourse was shackled to a restrictive, transactional matrix: Outright procurement, licensed assembly, and the familiar promises of the so-called "transfer of technology" (ToT). While these mechanisms may have met the immediate operational needs of a previous era, they are entirely insufficient for a nation asserting its place as an unyielding global power.

The definitive question for our defence planners is no longer what technology platforms India can buy, but when a multi-billion-dollar defence contract concludes, what permanent technological capabilities are left behind on Indian soil for us to carry forward.

This paradigm shift must even dictate our execution of the flagship Advanced Medium Combat Aircraft (AMCA) programme. Public debate around this fifth-generation fighter heavily obsesses over production timelines, thrust-to-weight ratios, and short-term capital allocations. However, the true national dividend of the AMCA project lies not simply in the stealth fighters rolling off the assembly line, but in the comprehensive, independent industrial architecture we build around it.

True aerospace sovereignty cannot be imported in a crate. Historically, nations that have sustained a dominant combat aviation edge did not do so via isolated, transactional purchases. They built a sprawling domestic web of advanced engineering talent, sovereign airworthiness certification authorities, complex testing infrastructures, and an industrial base of precision suppliers. These networks are

genuine national assets and foundational structures designed to birth successive generations of home-grown platforms.

Conventional outright buys or conventional ToT models have frequently acted as gilded cages. To shatter this cycle, the AMCA programme can be an example to demonstrate as a nation-building catalyst. Indian industry must rapidly graduate from being a low-tier assembly destination to an independent hub of design authority and precision engineering.

Achieving true resilience demands the systematic cultivation of a local supplier ecosystem capable of manufacturing high-tolerance spares and precision-engineered sub-systems. India needs a formidable network of private and public technology champions who can match global aerospace standards while keeping the intellectual and physical capital anchored at home.

This requires an aggressive, targeted focus on the building blocks of modern military propulsion. Precision machining ecosystems are a huge area for Indian defence tech startups and MSMEs capable of manufacturing complex sub-components down to sub-micron tolerances.

Establishing local foundry capabilities for specialised super alloys and complex advanced coatings is a must. Ensure that the entire spare part loop, from initial digital design to casting, is completely insulated from external sanctions or regional geopolitical pressures. By establishing this structural depth, India can transition

from a net consumer of aerospace parts to an independent global node in advanced manufacturing.

This domestic industrial revolution requires a clean break from conventional international partnerships. As India evaluates strategic options for the AMCA-Mk2 engine, the benchmark must look past immediate technology access. The most valuable alliances are those that treat India not as a captive consumer market, but as an equal co-development hub.

Consider the immense strategic advantage of aligning with an engine partner uniquely prepared to co-create a dedicated, sovereign aero gas-turbine complex inside India. The ideal collaborator is one that moves away from modified legacy engines and instead offers a clean-sheet, next-generation engine designed, engineered, and manufactured from scratch on Indian soil.

The ultimate differentiator in this model is the total relinquishment of intellectual property (IP) barriers. When a partner offers joint ownership of core IP, they hand India the keys to the propulsion kingdom. This gives our scientists and engineers the absolute freedom to modify, scale, and upgrade the engine architecture for future sixth-generation platforms or naval variants without seeking permission from foreign boards or capitals.

Furthermore, this model directly unlocks the most fiercely guarded frontiers of metallurgy. True collaboration means mastering the capability to mass-produce

single-crystal turbine blades and advanced thermal barrier coatings locally. Cultivating the specialised knowledge to cast a turbine blade as a single, flawless crystal capable of operating under immense centrifugal forces and temperatures exceeding is precisely what transforms India from a buyer to an aerospace peer.

The history of leading aerospace nations proves that advanced propulsion cannot be achieved through shortcuts; it is an incremental journey built across generations. By entering a co-development architecture that guarantees full IP rights and domestic manufacturing depth, India can leapfrog decades of trial and error.

The legacy of the AMCA project must not be a fleet of advanced aircraft reliant on foreign lifelines for propulsion and spares. Its ultimate triumph must be the creation of a sophisticated domestic engineering ecosystem, unmatched industrial depth, and the strategic resilience needed to secure our skies on our own terms. That is the true definition of a self-reliant India and it is an opportunity we must boldly claim. The OEMs willing to go on these parameters and co-developing as well as collaborating to produce precision engineering and components should be given preferential access whether in defence tech or even civilian purchases, including passenger civilian planes.

India needs to shift the benchmark from a passive transfer of technology to a true peer-level partnership that is sanction-proof and builds local capabilities in parallel. India then stops being a captive destination for assembly and transforms into a global power centre for advanced propulsion design.

●Write to us at feletters@expressindia.com

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

AI infra challenge

"Powering AI" (FE, September 11)

offers a timely reminder that AI is not merely a software race but an infrastructure challenge. While everyone focuses on chips, models, and talent, the real constraint may soon be electricity, cooling, water, and transmission. AI data centres consume enormous power continuously, and a few large campuses can strain local

grids and water systems. The answer is not subsidies or picking winners, but coordinated planning that aligns power generation, renewable energy, connectivity, and water use with where such facilities should be built. Efficiency standards help, yet location decisions must consider grid capacity and water availability. The race for AI must not outrun the infrastructure needed to sustain it.

—K Chidanand Kumar, Bengaluru

Coordinated planning

AI is rapidly pushing up demand for electricity, making reliable and affordable power a priority. We need to calculate AI infrastructure needs before power, transmission, and connectivity become bottlenecks. Well integrated AI infrastructure policy should evolve around power, transmission, renewable energy, telecom, water, and industrial planning. It should

identify locations for large computing clusters where power generation, grid capacity, fibre connectivity, and industrial infrastructure can work together. Such coordinated planning will help India scale AI faster while ensuring energy security and sustainability. Powering AI is no longer a choice, it is the need of the hour.

—PV Prakash, Mumbai

Motobahn

SATURDAY, SEPTEMBER 12, 2026



BMW'S FLAGSHIP
Hardeep Brar, President & CEO, BMW Group India

The new 7 Series is more than our flagship sedan, it is our ultimate statement of modern luxury, one that moves leaders, changemakers, visionaries.



● POWER PLATES: PIT STOP KHARU

Ladakhi lunch, Himalayan punch

RIDING A BIKE TO A WOMEN-LED VEGETARIAN DINER NEAR LEH

VIKRAM CHAUDHARY

BEFORE BRUCE LEE, sheer size dictated power. But Lee proved that precision can beat brute force. The Royal Enfield Himalayan 450 operates on a similar philosophy. You don't need a 1,000cc-plus Ducati or Triumph to enjoy long rides when a 452cc single-cylinder can deliver that level of punch 90% of the time.

But this column isn't about bikes; it's about a restaurant that matches the Himalayan cc to cc.

Pit Stop Kharu, near Leh

The journey begins with a crawl in traffic on the Leh-Manali road (NH3), towards Thiksey, making you realise the Himalayan is good, but not great. Its limited low-end torque requires frequent gear shifts in stop-and-go traffic. But once past Thiksey Monastery, the road opens up, and so does the Himalayan's real character — accelerating from 60 to 90 km/h in fifth gear happens in the blink of an eye, and on sweeping



Pit Stop Kharu is run by a local women's self-help group

mountain curves, its chassis and Ceat tyres turn riding into nirvana.

A vegetarian paradise

Called Pit Stop Kharu, it is run by a local women's Self-Help Group (SHG) under Royal Enfield's Social Mission. It is vegetarian, respecting its proximity to Hemis Monastery. The ground floor houses local art, souvenirs, clean washrooms. But



Food items in the main photo are fresh Sea Buckthorn juice (₹150); Cha Khante (₹70), a salted butter tea; Mok-mok (₹200) steamed with cabbage, carrot, soya, and paneer; and Khambir (₹200), a sourdough bun

was heavy on carbs — perfect if you are burning hundreds of calories on a trek. Similarly, Chhutagi (₹200), a bowtie-pasta dumpling soup, came with boiled vegetables, though I would have preferred a higher ratio of veggies to heavy pasta dough. The highlight was the vegetarian Mok-mok (₹200). Steamed with cabbage, carrot, soya, and paneer, its chilli-masala sauce was so addictive I could eat plate after plate. I finished with Cha Khante (₹70), a salted, churned butter tea whose acquired taste takes getting used to.

Beyond the kitchen

Since opening in August 2023, Pit Stop Kharu has drawn over 4,500 visitors, and the women running it have expanded their footprint beyond Ladakh, hosting food pop-ups at the Motoverse (in Goa), Khelo India Winter Games (Leh and Gulmarg), and showcases in Delhi and Mumbai. A second such pit stop is set to open in Babeli, Himachal Pradesh, utilising seismic-resistant Dhajji-Diwari architecture. Lastly, Pit Stop Kharu and the Himalayan 450 share a common theme: high-altitude performance, balanced by real-world honesties.

(*'Power plates' is a column in which we travel to unique restaurants, connecting the flavours with the vehicle.*)

Personal Finance

Grab the credit cards that have the best offers this festive season

GET THE ONES THAT OFFER HIGHER VALUE-BACK IN YOUR KEY SPENDING CATEGORIES

TAP TO SHOP

Cashback benefits							
10% cashback on food delivery, dining, grocery, utility bill payments	7.5% cashback on Myntra*, 5% on Flipkart and Cleartrip	7.5% cashback on all eligible (online and offline) grocery spends	6% cashback on dining and travel, capped at ₹3,000 per month	5% cashback on online spends, capped at ₹2,000 per month	5% cashback on Amazon, Flipkart, Myntra, Tata CLiQ, Swiggy, Zomato	5% on Amazon for Amazon Prime members, 3% for non-prime members	5% on select domestic online spends, 1% cashback on other spends
HSBC Live+ Credit Card	Flipkart Axis Bank Credit Card	Federal Bank Paisabazaar Credit Card	YES BANK PaisaSave Credit Card	Cashback SBI Card	HDFC Millennia Credit Card	Amazon Pay ICICI Credit Card	BOBCARD Cashback
₹999 + taxes	₹500 + taxes (No Joining Fee from Sep 1 to Sep 30, 2026)	₹500 + taxes	₹499 + taxes (No Joining Fee)	₹999 + taxes	₹1,000 + taxes	Nil	₹499 + taxes
Annual fee							

SAIKAT NEOGI

WITH THE FESTIVE season around the corner, using credit cards that offer higher cashback on shopping can help manage expenses more efficiently. Co-branded cards can be particularly relevant for those who prefer shopping on the associated platforms.

First, analyse your spending pattern and the rewards on offer. A card that maps your biggest expense such as buying gadgets, apparel, dining, or travel will deliver better

value. When used for planned purchases and paid off in full, cashback and rewards can help reduce the overall cost of spending.

“Rather than relying on one card for every purchase, consumers should align cards and choose the ones that offer higher value-back in their key spending categories,” says Santosh Agarwal, chief executive officer, Paisabazaar.

Those who prefer multiple plat-

Check if the card also offers sizeable benefits on spending throughout the year

forms can find better value in cards that provide attractive cashback across specific categories, irrespective of the merchant or platform.

The right card depends on where and how much you normally spend rather than simply the highest advertised cashback rate. Adhil Shetty, CEO, BankBazaar, says a card offering 5% cashback on a category you rarely use may be less useful than

one offering 2% on categories where you regularly spend. “Check the cashback rate, spending caps, exclusions and redemption conditions,” he says. The annual fee matters, particularly if it is waived only after reaching a certain spending level.

Festive offers can provide attractive rewards, but they are usually available for a limited period. A card should also offer useful benefits on spending throughout the year. Year-round rewards can make it easier to assess whether the benefits justify the annual fee.

● YOUR QUERIES: INCOME TAX

File revised ITR if you have omitted late dividends

● I have received dividends of some bonds last month for FY 25. I filed my returns in July. Should I now file revised returns or declare the dividends in next year's IT return?

—Gaurav Sharma

Dividend or interest income is taxable in the financial year it is declared, distributed, or paid, whichever is earlier. Since, the dividend was declared in FY 2025-26, it accrued as your taxable 'income from other sources' for that specific financial year, irrespective of when it was actually credited to your bank account. As you have already filed your original Income Tax Return (ITR) in July for FY 2025-26 and omitted this payout, you may file a revised return. Accordingly, you can compute and discharge any differential tax liability, along with applicable statutory interest, prior to submitting the revised ITR.

● I have prepaid my home loan in five years without taking any tax benefit. How can I take the tax benefit now as I have got possession now?

—Hitesh Kumar

Tax benefits for principal repayment are available only after property possession and in the financial year the repayment is made. Since you prepaid the loan before obtaining possession, you cannot retrospectively claim this benefit now. However, for the interest component paid during the pre-construction/acquisition phase, the Act permits relief under section 22 of Income-tax Act 2025. You can claim the accumulated pre-construction/acquisition interest in five equal annual instalments starting from the financial year in which possession was received, subject to the statutory limits under 'Income from House Property'. Additionally, the interest deduction is



available under the old tax regime for both self-occupied and let-out properties, subject to the applicable limits. However, under the new tax regime, the deduction is available only in respect of a let-out property.

● I get interest from deposits. Should I pay some advance tax in September?

—Ravish Rana

If your total estimated tax liability for the financial year, after deducting tax deducted at source, exceeds ₹10,000, you are required to pay advance tax. However, a resident senior citizen who does not have income chargeable under the head 'profits and gains of business or profession' does not have to pay advance tax. So, if you are not covered by this exemption and your interest income results in a net tax liability exceeding ₹10,000, you must pay advance tax in the prescribed instalments. To avoid interest liability, at least 45% of the total estimated advance tax should be paid by September 15.

The writer is managing partner, AKM Global. Send your queries to fepersonalfinance@expressindia.com



AMIT MAHESHWARI



GOVERNMENT OF INDIA

NATIONAL COMPANY LAW TRIBUNAL AHMEDABAD BENCH-I

1st and 2nd Floor, Corporate Bhawan Beside Zydus Hospital,

Off S.G. Highway Thaltej, Ahmedabad-380 059.

Phone No. (079) 2685 4591, Email: courtofficer-ahm@nclt.gov.in

PUBLICATION NOTICE OF NEXT DATE OF HEARING.

IA/1365(AHM)2026 in C.P.(IB)/87(AHM)2026

**Fortune Assets Private Limited Through ARCK Resolution Professionals LLP
being the RP Through Authorised Signatory Designated Partner Mr. Anil Kohli**

V/s

Edelweiss Asset Reconstruction Company Limited & Ors.

NCLT/AHM/Pub/IA/1365(AHM)2026 C.P.(IB)/87(AHM)2026/ 3561 /2026.

An application under Section 60(5) of the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code, 2016 read with Rule 11 of National Company Law Tribunal Rules, 2016 was filed by the Fortune Assets Private Limited Through ARCK Resolution Professionals LLP being the RP Through Authorised Signatory Designated Partner Mr. Anil Kohli and was listed for hearing on **09.09.2026** and the said application is now fixed for hearing before the Hon'ble Tribunal, NCLT Ahmedabad Bench-I on **05.10.2026**.

As per the direction issued by the Hon'ble Tribunal vide its order dated **09.09.2026**, the Respondents, **RANJANA GOYAL (R-5), NEERJA SHARMA (R-6), ADISH JAIN (R-7), VIRENDER AGGARWAL (R-8), AJAY GUPTA (R-9), MAHESH MALHOTRA (R-10), YOGESH KUMAR KATHURIA (R-11), AMAR KALA (R-12), DINESH AGGARWAL (R-13), RAJESH KUMAR (R-14), GULSHAN RAI MIDHA (R-15), PUNEET TRIPATHI (R-16), NEENA CHOPRA (R-17), SUDESH (R-18), AMRIT PAL SINGH MALHOTRA (R-19), SHREE SHARDA CHAINS P. LTD. (R-20), RATAN INDUSTRIES P. LTD. (R-21), DAYA KISHAN GOEL (R-22), AKHIL KR. GUPTA (R-23), VIVEK GUPTA (R-24), SANJAY CHADHA (R-25), GULSHAN ARORA (R-26), SHIVANI NAGPAL (R-27), PUNITA BANSAL (R-28), SHARDA DHANANJANI (R-29), SHASHI LATA (R-30), MEETA GULATI (R-31), BALJIT SINGH (R-32), SEEMA (R-33), SADHANA KUMARI (R-34), LEVI EPHRAIM KATY (R-35), ANITA RANI (R-36), JAGDISH CHANDRA BANSAL (R-37), ASHU JAIN (R-38), PUJA MAKHIJA (R-39), KRISHNA KUMAR CHAUDHARY (R-40)** are hereby directed to remain present through himself or through authorized person or through director or through an advocate or Professional duly appointed by you, as may be advised on **05.10.2026 at 10.30 A.M.** before the National Company Law Tribunal, Ahmedabad Bench-I. You are further directed to file reply, if any, within **seven days** physically as well as through e-mode from the date of publication of notice with advance copy to the opposite side.

TAKE NOTICE that in default of your appearance on the specified day & time the matter will be heard and determined in your absence in accordance with the provisions of law.

Date : 09.09.2026
Place : Ahmedabad

Sd/-
Court Officer
NCLT Ahmedabad Bench-I

THIS IS A PUBLIC ANNOUNCEMENT FOR INFORMATION PURPOSES ONLY AND IS NOT A PROSPECTUS ANNOUNCEMENT. THIS DOES NOT CONSTITUTE AN INVITATION OR OFFER TO ACQUIRE, PURCHASE OR SUBSCRIBE TO SECURITIES. THIS PUBLIC ANNOUNCEMENT IS NOT INTENDED FOR PUBLICATION OR DISTRIBUTION, DIRECTLY OR INDIRECTLY OUTSIDE INDIA.

PUBLIC ANNOUNCEMENT



(Please refer to the Draft Red Herring Prospectus & Draft Abridged Prospectus)



Marco Secure Solutions Limited

"Customer Satisfaction is Paramount for us"

MARCO SECURE SOLUTIONS LIMITED

Corporate Identity Number: U71100PN2019PLC184570

Our Company was originally incorporated as 'Marco Secure Solutions Private Limited' a private limited company under the provisions of Companies Act, 2013, pursuant to a certificate of incorporation dated June 4, 2019, issued by the Registrar of Companies, Central Registration Centre. Thereafter, name of our Company was changed from 'Marco Secure Solutions Private Limited' to 'Marco Secure Solutions Limited', consequent to conversion of our Company from private to public company, pursuant to a special resolution passed by the shareholders in extra ordinary general meeting of our Company held on September 15, 2025 and a fresh certificate of incorporation consequent to conversion of the company was issued by the Registrar of Companies, Central Processing Centre on October 7, 2025. For details of the change in registered office of our Company, see "History and Certain Corporate Matters" on page 222 of the Draft Red Herring Prospectus.

Registered Office: Fullora, Floor No. 2 & 3, Survey No. 28/2, CTS No. 458 B/15, Tejas Cooperative Housing Society, Paud Road, Kothrud, Pune- 411038, Maharashtra, India;

Contact Person: Bhushan Kulkarni, Company Secretary and Compliance Officer;

Tel No.: +91 20 6781 4365 • **Website:** www.marcosolutions.co.in • **E-mail:** info@marcosolutions.co.in

DETAILS OF THE ISSUE

INITIAL PUBLIC OFFER OF UPTO 33,74,000 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10/- EACH ("EQUITY SHARES") OF OUR COMPANY AT AN ISSUE PRICE OF ₹ [•] PER EQUITY SHARE (INCLUDING A SHARE PREMIUM OF ₹ [•] PER EQUITY SHARE) FOR CASH, AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ [•] LAKHS ("PUBLIC ISSUE") OUT OF WHICH [•] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10/- EACH, AT AN ISSUE PRICE OF ₹ [•] PER EQUITY SHARE FOR CASH, AGGREGATING ₹ [•] LAKHS WILL BE RESERVED FOR SUBSCRIPTION BY THE MARKET MAKER TO THE ISSUE (THE "MARKET MAKER RESERVATION PORTION"). THE PUBLIC ISSUE LESS MARKET MAKER RESERVATION PORTION I.E. ISSUE OF [•] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10/- EACH, AT AN ISSUE PRICE OF ₹ [•] PER EQUITY SHARE FOR CASH, AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ [•] LAKHS IS HEREINAFTER REFERRED TO AS THE "NET ISSUE". THE PUBLIC ISSUE AND NET ISSUE WILL CONSTITUTE [•] % AND [•] % RESPECTIVELY OF THE POST ISSUE PAID-UP EQUITY SHARE CAPITAL OF OUR COMPANY.

THE PRICE BAND AND THE MINIMUM BID LOT WILL BE DECIDED BY OUR COMPANY IN CONSULTATION WITH THE BRLM AND WILL BE ADVERTISED IN ALL EDITIONS OF [•] (A WIDELY CIRCULATED ENGLISH NATIONAL DAILY NEWSPAPER), ALL EDITIONS OF [•] (A WIDELY CIRCULATED HINDI NATIONAL DAILY NEWSPAPER), AND [•] EDITION OF [•] (A WIDELY CIRCULATED MARATHI REGIONAL DAILY NEWSPAPER, MARATHI BEING THE REGIONAL LANGUAGE OF MAHARASHTRA, WHERE OUR REGISTERED OFFICE IS LOCATED), AT LEAST TWO WORKING DAYS PRIOR TO THE BID/ISSUE OPENING DATE AND SHALL BE MADE AVAILABLE TO THE SME PLATFORM OF BSE LIMITED ("BSE SME") FOR THE PURPOSES OF UPLOADING ON ITS WEBSITE IN ACCORDANCE WITH SECURITIES AND EXCHANGE BOARD OF INDIA (ISSUE OF CAPITAL AND DISCLOSURE REQUIREMENTS) REGULATIONS, 2018, AS AMENDED (THE "SEBI ICDR REGULATIONS").

THE FACE VALUE OF THE EQUITY SHARE IS ₹10/- EACH AND THE FLOOR PRICE AND CAP PRICE ARE [•] TIMES AND [•] TIMES OF THE FACE VALUE OF THE EQUITY SHARES RESPECTIVELY.

In case of any revision in the Price Band, the Bid/Issue Period shall be extended for at least 3 (three) additional Working Days after such revision of the Price Band, subject to the total Bid/Issue Period not exceeding 10 (ten) Working Days. In cases of force majeure, banking strike or similar circumstances, our Company may, for reasons to be recorded in writing extend the Bid/Issue Period for a minimum of 1 (one) Working Day, subject to the Bid/Issue Period not exceeding 10 (ten) Working Days. Any revision in the Price Band, and the revised Bid/Issue Period, if applicable, shall be widely disseminated by notification to the Stock Exchanges by issuing a press release and also by indicating the change on the website of the BRLM and at the terminals of the Members of the Syndicate and by intimation to Designated Intermediaries and Sponsor Bank as applicable.

The Issue is being made through the Book Building Process, in terms of Rule 19(2)(b)(i) of the Securities Contracts (Regulation) Rules, 1957, as amended ("SCRR") read with Regulation 229(2) of the SEBI ICDR Regulations and in compliance with Regulation 253 of the SEBI ICDR Regulations, as amended, wherein not more than 50% of the Net Issue shall be allocated on a proportionate basis to Qualified Institutional Buyers ("QIBs", the "QIB Portion"), provided that our Company may, in consultation with the Book Running Lead Manager, allocate up to 60% of the QIB Portion to Anchor Investors on a discretionary basis in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations ("Anchor Investor Portion"). 40% of the Anchor Investor Portion shall be reserved for (i) 33.33% for domestic Mutual Funds; and (ii) 6.67% for Life Insurance Companies and Pension Funds and subject to valid Bids being received from the domestic Mutual Funds and Life Insurance Companies and Pension Funds, as applicable, at or above the price at which allocation will be made to Anchor Investors in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations and any under-subscription under (ii) above, may be allocated to domestic Mutual Funds. In the event of under-subscription, or non-allocation in the Anchor Investor Portion, the balance Equity Shares shall be added to the Net QIB Portion. Further, 5% of the Net QIB Portion shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis only to Mutual Funds, and the remainder of the Net QIB Portion shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis to all QIBs, including Mutual Funds, subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Issue Price. However, if the aggregate demand from Mutual Funds is less than 5% of the Net QIB Portion, the balance Equity Shares available for allocation in the Mutual Fund Portion will be added to the remaining Net QIB Portion for proportionate allocation to QIBs. Further, not less than 15% of the Net Issue shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis to Non-Institutional Bidders wherein (a) one third of the portion available to Non-Institutional Investors shall be reserved for Applicants with Application size of more than two lots and up to such lots equivalent to not more than ₹10 lakhs; (b) two third of the portion available to Non-Institutional Investors shall be reserved for Applicants with Application size of more than ₹10 lakhs; and (c) any unsubscribed portion in either of the sub-categories specified in clauses (a) or (b), may be allocated to Applicants in the other sub-category of Non-Institutional Investors; and not less than 35% of the Net Issue shall be available for allocation to Individual Bidders in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations, subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Issue Price. All potential Bidders (except Anchor Investors) are required to mandatorily utilize the Application Supported by Blocked Amount ("ASBA") process providing details of their respective ASBA accounts, and UPI ID in case of Individual Bidders using the UPI Mechanism, if applicable, in which the corresponding Bid Amounts will be blocked by the SCSBs or by the Sponsor Bank under the UPI Mechanism, as the case may be, to the extent of respective Bid Amounts. Anchor Investors are not permitted to participate in the Issue through the ASBA process. For details, see "Issue Procedure" beginning on page 380.

This public announcement is made in compliance with Regulation 247 of the SEBI ICDR Regulations, along with Notification no.: F. No. SEBI/LADNRO/GN/2025/233 dated March 3, 2025 and Securities and Exchange Board of India (Issue of Capital and Disclosure Requirements) (Amendment) Regulations, 2025, to inform the public that our Company is proposing, subject to applicable statutory and regulatory requirements, receipt of requisite approvals, market conditions and other considerations, to undertake initial public offering of its Equity Shares pursuant to the Issue and had filed the DRHP dated September 10, 2026 with SME Platform of BSE Limited ("BSE").

In relation to the above, the DRHP filed with SME Platform of BSE Limited ("BSE") shall be made available to the public for comments, if any, for a period of at least 21 days from the date of such filing by hosting it on the respective websites of the Stock Exchange i.e., BSE Limited at www.bseindia.com, website of the Company at www.marcosolutions.co.in and the website of the Book Running Lead Manager to the Issue i.e., Cumulative Capital Private Limited at www.cumulativecapitalgroup.com ("BRLM"). Our Company hereby invites the members of the public to give comments on the DRHP filed with SME Platform of BSE Limited with respect to disclosures made in the DRHP. The members of the public are requested to send a copy of their comments to SME Platform of BSE Limited and/or to the Company Secretary and Compliance Officer of our Company and/or the BRLM and/or Registrar to the Issue at their respective addresses mentioned herein below in relation to the Issue on or before 5:00 p.m. on the 21st day from the aforesaid date of filing the DRHP with SME Platform of BSE Limited.

Investments in equity and equity-related securities involve a degree of risk and investors should not invest any funds in this Issue unless they can afford to take the risk of losing their entire investment. Investors are advised to read the risk factors carefully before taking an investment decision in the Issue. For taking an investment decision, investors must rely on their own examination of our Company and the Issue including the risks involved. The Equity Shares issued in the Issue have not been recommended or approved by the Securities and Exchange Board of India ("SEBI"), nor does SEBI guarantee the accuracy or adequacy of the Draft Red Herring Prospectus. Specific attention of the investors is invited of the section titled "Risk Factors" beginning on page 23. Any decision to invest in the Equity Shares described in the DRHP may only be made after the Red Herring Prospectus ("RHP") has been filed with the RoC and must be made solely on the basis of such RHP as there may be material changes in the RHP from the DRHP. The Equity Shares, when offered, through the RHP, are proposed to be listed on the SME Platform of BSE Limited.

For details of the main objectives of our Company as contained in its Memorandum of Association, see "History and Certain Corporate Matters" on page 222 of the Draft Red Herring Prospectus. The liability of the members of our Company is limited. For details of the share capital, capital structure of our Company, the names of the signatories to the Memorandum of Association and the number of shares of our Company subscribed by them of our Company, please see "Capital Structure" beginning on page 94 of the Draft Red Herring Prospectus.

BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGER	REGISTRAR TO THE ISSUE	COMPANY
Cumulative Capital Private Limited B 309-311, 215 Atrium, Nr. Courtyard Marriott Hotel, Andheri Kurla Road, Andheri East, Chakala MIDC, Mumbai, Maharashtra, India, 400093 Telephone: +91 981 966 2664 / +91 70399 51133 E-mail: contact@cumulativecapitalgroup.com Website: www.cumulativecapitalgroup.com Investor Grievance E-mail: investor@cumulativecapitalgroup.com Contact Person: Swapnilsagar Vithalani / Foram Kirti Kapoor SEBI Registration Number: INM000013129	MUGF Intime India Private Limited (Formerly Link Intime India Private Limited) C-101, Embassy 247, L. B. S. Marg, Vikhroli (West), Mumbai 400083, Maharashtra, India. Telephone: +91 810 811 4949 Email: marcosecure.smeipo@in.mpmg.mugf.com Website: www.in.mpmg.mugf.com Investor Grievance E-mail: marcosecure.smeipo@in.mpmg.mugf.com Contact Person: Ms. Shanti Gopalkrishnan SEBI Registration Number: INR000004058	Marco Secure Solutions Limited Fullora, Floor No. 2 & 3, Survey No. 28/2, CTS No. 458 B/15, Tejas Cooperative Housing Society, Paud Road, Kothrud, Pune- 411038, Maharashtra, India. Telephone: +91 20 6781 4365 E-mail: info@marcosolutions.co.in Website: www.marcosolutions.co.in Contact Person: Bhushan Kulkarni, Company Secretary and Compliance Officer CIN: U71100PN2019PLC184570

All capitalized terms used herein and not specifically defined shall have the same meaning as ascribed to them in the DRHP dated September 10, 2026.

Marco Secure Solutions Limited
on behalf of the Board of Directors

Sd/-

Place: Pune
Date: September 11, 2026
Bhushan Kulkarni
Company Secretary & Compliance Officer

Marco Secure Solutions Limited is proposing, subject to applicable statutory and regulatory requirements, receipt of requisite approvals, market conditions and other considerations, to undertake an Initial Public Offer of its Equity Shares and has filed the DRHP dated September 10, 2026 with the Stock Exchange. The DRHP shall be available on the website of the Stock Exchange i.e., BSE Limited at www.bseindia.com, website of the Company at www.marcosolutions.co.in and the website of the Book Running Lead Manager to the Issue i.e., Cumulative Capital Private Limited at www.cumulativecapitalgroup.com. Potential investors should note that investment in equity shares involves a high degree of risk and for details relating to such risks, please see the section entitled "Risk Factors" on page 23 of the Draft Red Herring Prospectus. Potential investors should not rely on the DRHP filed with the Stock Exchanges for making any investment decision, and should instead rely on the RHP, for making investment decision.

The Equity Shares have not been and will not be registered under the U.S. Securities Act of 1933 (the "U. S. Securities Act") or any state securities law in United States, and unless so registered, and may not be offered or sold within the United States, except pursuant to an exemption from, or in a transaction not subject to the registration requirements of the U. S. Securities Act and applicable U.S. state securities laws. This announcement has been prepared for publication in India and may not be released in the United States.

This announcement does not constitute an offer of securities for sale in any jurisdiction, including the United States, and any securities described in this announcement may not be offered or sold in the United States absent registration under the U.S. Securities Act of 1933, as amended, or an exemption from registration. Any public offering of securities to be made in the United States will be made by means of a prospectus that may be obtained from the Company and that will contain detailed information about the Company and management, as well as financial statements. There will be no public offering of the Equity Shares in the United States.



Regd. Office : One World Centre, Unit No. 1501B, Tower 1, 841, Jupiter Textile Mills, Senapati Bapat Marg, Lower Parel, Mumbai - 400013, Maharashtra, India.
Email : compliance@hiparks.com; **Website :** www.hiparks.com; **Telephone :** 91 + 22 4158 1000

HORIZON INDUSTRIAL PARKS LIMITED

CIN: U60231MH2009PLC222156

(INR in millions, except per share data)

Particulars	Standalone				Consolidated			
	Quarter ended*		Year Ended		Quarter ended*		Year Ended	
	30-Jun-26	31-Mar-26	30-Jun-25	31-Mar-26	30-Jun-26	31-Mar-26	30-Jun-25	31-Mar-26
	(Unaudited)	(Unaudited)	(Unaudited)	(Audited)	(Unaudited)	(Unaudited)	(Unaudited)	(Audited)
Total Income from operations	1,191.43	1,155.42	492.14	3,041.23	2,405.35	2,331.22	1,728.33	7,678.42
Profit / (Loss) before tax for the period / year	634.83	544.20	(115.78)	657.43	(69.08)	2.03	(637.46)	(1,972.93)
Profit / (Loss) after tax for the period / year	634.83	544.20	(115.78)	657.43	(116.27)	5.94	(654.98)	(2,036.49)
Other Comprehensive Income / (Loss) for the period / year	(0.64)	0.67	(14.53)	2.85	(3.22)	0.78	(14.93)	0.75
Total Comprehensive Income / (Loss) for the period / year	634.19	544.87	(130.31)	660.28	(119.49)	6.72	(669.91)	(2,035.74)
Paid up Equity Share Capital (Face value INR 10 per share)	24,495.26	24,495.26	9,051.98	24,495.26	24,495.26	24,495.26	9,051.98	24,495.26
Other Equity				47,223.65				32,145.41
Earnings per equity share (Face value of INR 10 each)								
Basic (* not annualised) (in INR)	0.26	0.22	(0.18)	0.39	(0.04)	0.00#	(1.00)	(1.18)
Diluted (* not annualised) (in INR)	0.26	0.22	(0.18)	0.39	(0.04)	0.00#	(1.00)	(1.18)

Denotes earnings per share less than rounding threshold

Notes:
1. Pursuant to Regulation 33 and 47 of Securities Exchange Board of India (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 and based on the recommendation of the Audit Committee and the Board of Directors of Horizon Industrial Parks Limited (the "Company") at their meeting held on September 11, 2026 have inter alia considered and approved the unaudited consolidated and standalone financial results for the quarter ended June 30, 2026 alongwith the Limited review report issued by the statutory auditors of the Company.
2. The above is an extract of the detailed format of quarterly financial results filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing and Other Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the quarterly financial results are available on the websites of the Stock Exchange(s) (www.bseindia.com, www.nseindia.com) and the listed entity - www.hiparks.com.

By order of the Board of Directors
For Horizon Industrial Parks Limited
(formerly known as Horizon Industrial Parks Private Limited) Sd/-
Urvish Rambhia
CEO and Wholtime Director
DIN: 09264582

Place: Mumbai
Date: September 11, 2026



SHREE RENUKA SUGARS LIMITED

CIN: L01542KA1995PLC019046

Regd. Office : 2nd & 3rd Floor, Kanakashree Arcade, CTS No. 10634, JNMCC Road, Neharu Nagar, Belagavi - 590010, Karnataka
Tel No.: +91-831-2404000 | **Website:** www.renukasugars.com
E-mail: groupcs@renukasugars.com

CORRIGENDUM TO THE NOTICE OF THE 30TH ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING OF SHREE RENUKA SUGARS LIMITED

This corrigendum is regarding the Notice of 30th Annual General Meeting dated 5th August 2026 ("AGM Notice") of Shree Renuka Sugars Limited ("the Company") scheduled on **Tuesday, 22nd September 2026 at 11:00 AM (IST)** through Video Conferencing ("VC"). The AGM Notice was dispatched to all the shareholders of the Company by way of email on 31st August 2026 in due compliance with the provisions of the Companies Act, 2013, and rules made thereunder, read with circulars issued by Ministry of Corporate Affairs and the Securities and Exchange Board of India and all other applicable provisions.

This Corrigendum is being issued to give notice of amended details as mentioned herein and pursuant to the provisions of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015.

- Item No. 3 of the AGM Notice be read as **Special Resolution** instead of Ordinary Resolution.
- The proposed resolution is added for Item No. 3 of the AGM Notice.
- Explanatory Statement added for Item No. 3 of the AGM Notice.

This corrigendum to the AGM Notice shall form an integral part of the AGM Notice. This corrigendum to the AGM Notice has already been circulated to the shareholders of the Company by way of email on 11th September 2026 and on and from the date hereof, the AGM Notice shall always be read in conjunction with this corrigendum. The corrigendum is available on the website of the Company at www.renukasugars.com, BSE Limited at www.bseindia.com, National Stock Exchange of India Limited at www.nseindia.com and on the website of KFin Technologies Limited at <https://evoting.kfintech.com>. All other contents of the AGM Notice, save and except as modified or supplemented by this corrigendum, shall remain unchanged.

For Shree Renuka Sugars Limited Sd/-

Date : 11th September 2026
Place : Mumbai

Deepak Manerikar
Company Secretary



RAYMOND REALTY LIMITED

CIN: L41000MH2019PLC332934
Registered Office: Jekagram, Pokhran Road No. 1, Thane (West), Pin Code - 400606, Maharashtra, India.
Tel.: +91 22 6837 3700
Email: ri.secretarial@raymond.in; **Website:** www.raymondrealty.in

INFORMATION REGARDING EXTRA-ORDINARY GENERAL MEETING TO BE HELD THROUGH VIDEO CONFERENCING ("VC") / OTHER AUDIO VISUAL MEANS ("OAVM")

NOTICE is hereby given that the Extra-Ordinary General Meeting ("EGM") of the Shareholders of Raymond Realty Limited ("the Company") will be held on **Thursday, October 08, 2026 at 12:00 Noon (IST)** through two-way VC/OAVM facility in compliance with relevant circulars issued by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs ("MCA") and the Securities and Exchange Board of India, to transact business set forth in the Notice of the EGM.

In compliance with the above Circulars, Notice of the EGM will be sent only through electronic mode to those Shareholders whose email address is registered with the Company/National Securities Depository Limited and Central Depository Services (India) Limited ("the Depositories")/ MUGF Intime India Private Limited (formerly known as Link Intime India Private Limited) ("RTA") as on September 11, 2026. A copy of the Notice of EGM will also be available on the website of the Company at www.raymondrealty.in, websites of the Stock Exchanges i.e. BSE Limited and National Stock Exchange of India Limited at www.bseindia.com, www.nseindia.com respectively, on the website of National Securities Depository Limited ("NSDL") at www.evoting.nsdl.com and on the website of MUGF Intime India Private Limited (formerly known as Link Intime India Private Limited) ("RTA") at <https://in.mpmg.mugf.com/>.

How to register/update email address and mobile number:

- In case the Shareholder(s) holding shares in physical mode has/have not registered e-mail address and mobile number, they may do so by sending a duly signed request letter to Registrar & Share Transfer Agent of the Company, MUGF Intime India Private Limited (formerly known as Link Intime India Private Limited) by providing Folio Number, Name of Shareholder, email ID and mobile number at (UNIT: Raymond Realty Limited), C-101, 247 Park, L.B.S. Marg, Vikhroli (West), Mumbai - 400083 or send a scanned copy of the signed request letter through e-mail to investor.helpdesk@in.mpmg.mugf.com with a copy to ri.secretarial@raymond.in.

- In case Shares are held in Demat mode, the Shareholders may contact their Depository Participant ("DP") and register their email address in their Demat account as per the process advised by the DP.

Remote E-voting

- The Company is providing remote e-voting facility ("remote e-voting") to all its Shareholders to cast their vote on all resolutions set out in the Notice of the EGM. Additionally, the Company is providing the facility of voting through e-voting system during the EGM ("e-voting"). Detailed procedure for joining the EGM and remote e-voting/e-voting is being provided in the Notice of EGM. Shareholders attending the EGM through VC/OAVM will be counted for the purpose of reckoning the quorum under Section 103 of the Companies Act, 2013.

Shareholders holding shares in physical form who have not registered their e-mail addresses with the Company can obtain Notice of the EGM, and/or login details for joining the EGM through VC/OAVM facility including remote e-voting/ e-voting, by providing a duly signed request letter with Folio No., name of the Shareholder, scanned copy of the share certificate (front and back), self-attested scanned copy of PAN and Aadhaar by e-mail to investor.helpdesk@in.mpmg.mugf.com or ri.secretarial@raymond.in.

Shareholders holding shares in demat mode who have not registered their e-mail address can obtain the Notice of the EGM, and/or login details for joining the EGM through VC/OAVM facility including remote e-voting/ e-voting, by providing a duly signed request letter with DPID-CLID (16-digit DPID + CLID or 16-digit beneficiary ID), name of the Shareholder, client master copy of Consolidated Account Statement, self-attested scanned copy of PAN and Aadhaar by e-mail to investor.helpdesk@in.mpmg.mugf.com or ri.secretarial@raymond.in. The detailed steps on casting vote through remote e-voting or through e-voting is mentioned in the Notice of EGM.

Manner of registering/ updating bank details:

- Shareholders holding shares in Demat mode are requested to register complete bank account details with the depository participants and Shareholders holding shares in physical mode shall send a duly signed request letter to MUGF Intime India Private Limited (formerly known as Link Intime India Private Limited) mentioning the name, folio no. bank details, self-attested PAN card and original cancelled cheque. In case of absence of name of the first Shareholder on the original cancelled cheque, bank attested copy of first page of the Bank Passbook/ Statement of Account in original along with the cancelled cheque should be provided.

The above information is being issued for the benefit of all the Shareholders of the Company in compliance with the relevant Circulars issued by MCA. This information is also available on the website of the Company at www.raymondrealty.in.
For further information, Shareholders may contact MUGF Intime India Private Limited (formerly known as Link Intime India Private Limited) quoting the Folio Number/DP ID and Client ID at, MUGF Intime India Private Limited, (UNIT: Raymond Realty Limited), C-101, 247 Park, L.B.S. Marg, Vikhroli (West), Mumbai - 400083, Email: investor.helpdesk@in.mpmg.mugf.com.

For RAYMOND REALTY LIMITED Sd/-

Date: September 11, 2026
Place: Thane

HIREN SONAWALA
COMPANY SECRETARY

PUBLIC NOTICE

(Under Section 99 of the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code, 2016)
FOR THE ATTENTION OF THE CREDITORS OF Mr. KANAKA SUBBU GANAPATHY (PERSONAL GUARANTOR TO M/s. PRC INTERNATIONAL HOTELS PRIVATE LIMITED)

RELEVANT PARTICULARS	
1 Name and Address of Personal Guarantor	Mr. Kanaka Subbu Ganapathy, No.38, Springwood Drive, Monroe Township, New Jersey - 08831.
2 Insolvency Commencement Date	07.09.2026
3 Details of Order admitting the application	Hon'ble NCLT Chennai Bench Order No: IA/IBC/1383/CHE/2025 IN CP/IB/102/CHE/2025 Dated 07.09.2026
4 Name and Registration Number of Resolution Professional	Dr. S.R. SHRIRAM SHEKHAR IBBI/IPA-03/IP-N000144/2017-2018/11598
5 Address and e-mail of the Resolution Professional, as registered with the Board	No. 11, Prayag Apartments, 8-15, Gandhi Nagar First Main Road, Ayer, Chennai - 600 020 E-mail: shekhershriram@gmail.com
6 Address and e-mail to be used for correspondence with the Resolution Professional/Claim Submission	No. 11, Prayag Apartments, 8-15, Gandhi Nagar First Main Road, Ayer, Chennai - 600 020 (Near Sangeetha Restaurant) E-mail: pg.kanakasubbuganapathy@gmail.com
7 Last date for submission of claims	05 th OCTOBER 2026
8 Relevant Forms are available at:	Form B Weblink: http://www.ibbi.gov.in/home/downloads

NOTICE is hereby given that the National Company Law Tribunal, Chennai (Bench-I) has ordered the commencement of Insolvency Resolution Process of Mr. Kanaka Subbu Ganapathy, No.38, Springwood Drive, Monroe Township, New Jersey - 08831. (Personal Guarantor to M/s. PRC INTERNATIONAL HOTELS PRIVATE LIMITED) from 07.09.2026. (Hon'ble NCLT Order was received by the RP on 10.09.2026).

SPANDANA SPHOORTY FINANCIAL LIMITED
CIN: L65929TG2003PLC040648
Registered Office: Galaxy, Wing B, 16th Floor, Plot No.1, Sy.No.83/1, Hyderabad Knowledge City, TSIC, Raidurg Panmaktha, Hyderabad, Ranga Reddy, Telangana-500081. Phone: +04048126666
Website: www.spandanaspfoorty.com, E-mail: shareholders@spandanaspfoorty.com

POSTAL BALLOT NOTICE AND E-VOTING INFORMATION

Pursuant to Sections 110 and 108 and other applicable provisions of the Companies Act, 2013 ("Act"), read with the applicable provisions of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 ("SEBI Listing Regulations"), the Companies (Management and Administration) Rules, 2014, Secretarial Standard-2 (SS-2), and the relevant MCA Circulars, as amended from time to time, the Company is conducting a postal ballot through remote e-voting to transact the special business and seek the approval of the Members by passing the resolution through electronic voting only ("remote e-Voting"). The special business proposed to be transacted and the resolution proposed for Members' approval is set out below:

- Appointment of Mr. Neeraj Swarop (DIN: 00061170) as an Independent Director of the Company.
- Date of completion of dispatch of Postal Ballot Notice to Members through e-mail - Friday, September 11, 2026.
- The Company has sent an e-mail for the Postal Ballot Notice dated September 11, 2026, to all the Members whose name appeared on the Register of Members/Record of Depositories received from National Securities Depository Limited/ Central Depositories Services (India) Limited (Depositories) as on Friday, September 04, 2026 (cut-off date) and whose e-mail addresses are registered with depository participant(s). A person who is not a Member as on the cut-off date should treat this advertisement for information purpose only.
- The voting rights of Members shall be in proportion to their shares in the paid-up equity share capital of the Company as on the cut-off date. Any subsequent change in the paid-up value of shares arising from a corporate action shall not affect the voting rights so determined.
- The requirement for sending physical Postal Ballot Notice to the Members have been dispensed with vide MCA Circulars.
- Details of the process and manner of remote e-voting along with the User ID and password are provided over e-mail to all Members who have registered their e-mail addresses. The instructions for voting through electronic means are provided to all Members as part of the Postal Ballot Notice.
- The Company has engaged KFin Technologies Limited ("KFinTech") for facilitating e-voting in a secure manner.
- For Members who have not registered their e-mail are requested to register their email addresses with the DP with whom their Demat Account is maintained.
- The date and time of commencement of voting through electronic means - **Monday, September 14, 2026, at 09.00 a.m. (IST).**
- The date and time of end of voting through electronic means - **Tuesday, October 13, 2026, at 5.00 p.m. (IST).**
- The remote e-voting platform will be disabled at 5:00 p.m. IST on **Tuesday, October 13, 2026** by KFinTech. Once the vote on resolution is cast by the Members, the Members shall not be allowed to change it subsequently.
- Website address where Postal Ballot Notice is displayed: Company - www.spandanaspfoorty.com and KFinTech <https://evoting.kfintech.com>. Postal Ballot Notice is also submitted to BSE Limited and National Stock Exchange of India Limited and the same are also available on their websites.
- In case of any queries/grievances, you may refer the Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs) for Members and e-voting User Manual available at the "download" section of <https://evoting.kfintech.com> or call KFin on 1-800-309-4001 (toll free).
- The Company has appointed Mr. Y.Ravi Prasada Reddy (Membership No. FCS 5783), Proprietor, RPR & Associates, Practicing Company Secretaries (CP No. 5360), Hyderabad as Scrutinizer for conducting the remote e-voting process thereto in accordance with the provisions of the Act read with the Rules and the MCA Circulars in a fair and transparent manner.

The results of the remote e-voting will be declared on or before Thursday, October 15, 2026, at the registered office of the Company, the results of the remote e-voting along with the scrutiner's report will be uploaded on the Company's website www.spandanaspfoorty.com and will be communicated to the National Stock Exchange of India Limited at www.nseindia.com and BSE Limited at www.bseindia.com, where the equity shares / securities of the Company are listed.

By the Order of the Board of Directors
For Spandana Sphoorty Financial Limited
Vinay Prakash Tripathi
Company Secretary

Place: Hyderabad
Date: September 11, 2026

NOTICE
Motilal Oswal Financial Services Limited
SEBI Registration No.: INZ000158836
Member of Multi Commodity Exchange of India Limited (MCX); Member ID 55930, BSE Limited (BSE) Clearing No.: 446,
National Stock Exchange of India Ltd (NSE) Member ID 10412 (NCDEX) ID 1240
Registered office Address of Member: Motilal Oswal Tower, Rahimtullah Sayani Road, Opposite Parel ST Depot,
Prabhadevi, Mumbai - 400 025, Tel No.: 022-7193 4200.

This is to inform all concerned that we have initiated the process of cancellation of registration of our below mentioned Authorised Person (AP) due to regulatory reasons/concerns.

Exchange	Name of AP	Trade Name of AP	Address of AP	AP Registration No.
MCX	GOVINDBHAI RAMJIBHAI VALAND	GOVINDBHAI RAMJIBHAI VALAND	FF-5, ABHILASHA SQUARE NEW SAMA ROAD NEAR ABHILASHA CHAR RASTA EME SCHOOL VADODARA - 390024 GUJARAT, INDIA.	MCX/AP/123815
BSE	GOVINDBHAI RAMJIBHAI VALAND	GOVINDBHAI RAMJIBHAI VALAND	FF-5, ABHILASHA SQUARE NEW SAMA ROAD NEAR ABHILASHA CHAR RASTA EME SCHOOL VADODARA - 390024, GUJARAT, INDIA.	AP0104460168342
NSE	GOVINDBHAI RAMJIBHAI VALAND	GOVINDBHAI RAMJIBHAI VALAND	FF-5 ABHILASHA SQUARE NEW SAMA ROAD NEAR ABHILASHA CHAR RASTA EME SCHOOL VADODARA - 390024, GUJARAT, INDIA.	AP0297102971
NCDEX	GOVINDBHAI RAMJIBHAI VALAND	GOVINDBHAI RAMJIBHAI VALAND	FF-5 ABHILASHA SQUARE NEW SAMA ROAD NEAR ABHILASHA CHAR RASTA EME SCHOOL VADODARA - 390024, GUJARAT, INDIA.	119022

Any person dealing with the above-mentioned Authorised Person henceforth shall do so at their own risk. **Motilal Oswal Financial Services Limited** shall not be liable for any dealings with the said entity post the issuance of this notice.

Investors having any queries or concerns regarding this matter are requested to contact **Motilal Oswal Financial Services Limited** within **15 days** from the date of issuing this notice.

For Motilal Oswal Financial Services Limited
Sd/-
Authorised Signatory

Date: September 11, 2026
Place: Mumbai

PUBLIC NOTICE
Titan Company Limited
Registered Office : "INTEGRITY", No. 193, Veerasandra, Electronics City
P.O. - Off Hosur Main Road, Bangalore - 560100
TO WHOMSOEVER IT MAY CONCERN

NOTICE is hereby given that the certificate[s] for the under mentioned securities of the Company has/have been lost/misplaced and the holder[s] of the said securities / applicant[s] has/have applied to the Company to issue duplicate certificate.

Name of the Shareholder	Folio No.	Face Value	Certificate Number Start - End	Distinctive Number Start - End	No of Shares
RAJALAKSHMI GOLCHHA	TWR0009356	Rs. 1 Each	10101	23645981 - 23647890	2000

The Public are hereby cautioned against purchasing or dealing in any way with the above referred share certificates. Any person who has any claim in respect of the said share certificate[s] should lodge such claim with the company or its Registrar and Transfer Agent MUFG Intime India Private Limited 247 Park, C-101, 1 Floor, L.B.S. Marg, Vikhroli (W) Mumbai - 400083. TEL : 8108116767 within 15 days of publication of this notice after which no claim will be entertained and the Company shall proceed to issue with the Duplicate Share Certificate[s].

Place : Kolkata
Date : 10.09.2026

Name of the holder :
RAJALAKSHMI GOLCHHA

BAYER CROPSCIENCE LIMITED
CIN: L24210MH1958PLC011173
Regd. Office: Bayer House, Central Avenue, Hiranandani Estate, Thane (West) - 400 607.
Tel No.: 022-2531 1234; Fax No.: 022-2545 5063
Mobile No.: +91 77009 10499
Website: www.bayer.in; Email: ir_bcs@bayer.com

POSTAL BALLOT NOTICE AND REMOTE E-VOTING INFORMATION

Notice is hereby given to the Members of Bayer CropScience Limited ("the Company") that, pursuant to and in compliance with Section 108 and Section 110 of the Companies Act, 2013 ("Act") read with Rule 20 and Rule 22 of the Companies (Management and Administration) Rules, 2014, ("Rules"), Regulation 44 of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015, ("SEBI Listing Regulations"), Secretarial Standard-2 on General Meetings ("SS-2") issued by The Institute of Company Secretaries of India and in terms of the Circular No. 14/2020 dated April 8, 2020, Circular No. 17/2020 dated April 13, 2020, Circular No. 22/2020 dated June 15, 2020, Circular No. 33/2020 dated September 28, 2020, Circular No. 39/2020 dated December 31, 2020, Circular No. 10/2021 dated June 23, 2021, Circular No. 20/2021 dated December 8, 2021, Circular No. 3/2022 dated May 5, 2022, Circular No. 11/2022 dated December 28, 2022, Circular No. 09/2023 dated September 25, 2023 and Circular No. 09/2024 dated September 19, 2024 along with subsequent circulars issued in this regard and the latest Circular No. 03/2025 dated September 22, 2025 issued by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs ("MCA Circulars"), and other applicable provisions of the Act and Rules made thereunder and the SEBI Listing Regulations, as amended from time to time, (including any statutory modification(s) or re-enactment(s) thereof for the time being in force), the following Resolution is proposed for approval of the Members of the Company through Postal Ballot only, by voting through electronic means ("Postal Ballot" / "Remote e-Voting"), as set out in this Notice:

Sr. No.	Type of Resolution	Brief Description
1	Special	Appointment of Mr. Ravi Moti Kirpalani (Mr. Ravi Kirpalani) (DIN: 02613688) as the Non-Executive Independent Director of the Company

The Postal Ballot Notice will be available on the Company's website at www.bayer.in, website of National Securities Depository Limited ("NSDL") at www.evoting.nsdl.com and website of BSE Limited at www.bseindia.com.

In accordance with the aforesaid MCA Circulars, the Company has sent the Postal Ballot Notice on Friday, September 11, 2026, only through electronic mode to those members whose Email addresses are registered with the Company/Depositories and whose names are recorded in the Register of Members of the Company or in the Register of Beneficial Owners maintained by the Depositories as on **Monday, September 07, 2026 ('Cut-off Date')**. Voting rights of the members shall be in proportion to the shares held by them in the paid-up equity share capital of the Company as on Cut-off Date. Communication of assent or dissent of the Members whose names are recorded in the Register of Members of the Company or in the Register of Beneficial Owners maintained by the Depositories as on the Cut-off Date will be entitled to cast their votes by remote e-Voting. A person who is not a member as on the relevant date should treat this Notice for information purposes only.

The Company has engaged the services of NSDL to provide remote e-Voting facility to its members. The members may cast their votes during the period mentioned herein below:

Commencement of remote e-Voting	Monday, September 14, 2026 at 09.00 A.M. (IST)
End of remote e-Voting	Tuesday, October 13, 2026 at 05.00 P.M. (IST)

The remote e-Voting module shall be disabled by NSDL thereafter. Once the vote is cast by the Member, he/she shall not be allowed to change it subsequently.

Members holding shares in physical form are requested to submit their PAN, KYC details including bank details and nomination details to the Company's Registrar and Share Transfer Agent, MUFG Intime India Private Limited (MUFG Intime) (formerly Link Intime India Private Limited) through Form ISR - 1 and other applicable forms. The Investor Service Request forms are available at www.bayer.in in case of holdings in physical form. The Members whose Email addresses are not registered with the Company/Depositories, and who wish to receive the Postal Ballot Notice may register on or before 05:00 P.M. (IST), Tuesday, October 06, 2026, by clicking the link : https://web.in.mpms.mufg.com/EmailReg/Email_Register.html and complete the registration process as guided therein.

For details relating to e-Voting, please refer the Frequently Asked Questions ("FAQs") for Shareholders and e-Voting user manual for Shareholders available at the download section of www.evoting.nsdl.com or call on : 022 - 4886 7000 or send a request to Ms. Pallavi Mhatre, DVP - NSDL at evoting@nsdl.com.

Scrutinizer for remote e-Voting and declaration of remote e-Voting results:

The Board of Directors of the Company has appointed CS S. N. Viswanathan, (Membership No. FCS 13685 / CP No. 24335), Managing Partner, or failing him CS Ashwini R. Vartak, (Membership No. ACS 29463/CP No. 16723), Partner of M/s. S. N. Ananthasubramanian & Co., Company Secretaries, to act as the Scrutinizer, to scrutinize the voting conducted during the Postal Ballot process, in a fair and transparent manner.

The resolution, if approved by requisite majority, shall be deemed to have been passed on the last date of remote e-Voting i.e., **Tuesday, October 13, 2026**. The result of remote e-Voting will be announced on or before Wednesday, October 14, 2026. The results declared along with the Scrutinizer's Report shall be placed on the Company's website at www.bayer.in, website of the Stock Exchange i.e. BSE Limited at www.bseindia.com and on the website of NSDL, i.e. www.evoting.nsdl.com immediately after the declaration of results. The Scrutinizer's decision on the validity of the Postal Ballot shall stand final.

For Bayer CropScience Limited
Sd/-
Bharati Shetty
Company Secretary & Compliance Officer
(Membership No.: ACS 24199)

Place: Thane
Date: September 12, 2026

QUANTUM MUTUAL FUND
FOR THOUGHTFUL INVESTORS

Investment Manager: Quantum Asset Management Company Private Limited
1st Floor, Aseesaj House, 3 Dinkhwa Vachha Road, Backbay Reclamation, Churchgate, Mumbai - 400020
Toll Free No.: 1800-209-3863 / 1800-22-3963 Email: CustomerCare@QuantumAMC.com
Website: www.QuantumAMC.com CIN: U55990MH2005PTC156152

Notice
NOTICE NO. 05/2026

Notice is hereby given that the Board of Directors of Quantum Trustee Company Private Limited has approved the declaration of Income Distribution cum Capital Withdrawal ("IDCW") under the following Schemes of Quantum Mutual Fund:

Scheme Name	Plan/Option	IDCW (Rs. Per Unit)	Face Value (Rs. Per Unit)	NAV Per Unit as on September 10, 2026 (Rs.)
Quantum Value Fund	Direct Plan - IDCW Option	0.80	10.00	122.47
	Regular Plan - IDCW Option	0.80	10.00	115.57
Quantum ELSS Tax Saver Fund	Direct Plan - IDCW Option	0.46	10.00	121.37
	Regular Plan - IDCW Option	0.46	10.00	114.18
Quantum Diversified Equity All Cap Active FOF	Direct Plan - IDCW Option	1.00	10.00	85.769
	Regular Plan - IDCW Option	1.00	10.00	83.868

Pursuant to payment of IDCW, the NAV of the abovementioned IDCW option of the schemes/plans would fall to the extent of payout and statutory levy, if any.

The Record Date for the purpose of distribution of IDCW will be September 17, 2026. In case the Record Date falls on a Non-Business Day, the immediately following Business Day shall be the Record Date. All the Unitholders / Beneficial Owners of the abovementioned scheme / plan / option whose names appear in the records of Registrar / Depositories as on the Record Date shall be entitled to receive IDCW. The investors in the IDCW re-investment option will be allotted units for the IDCW amount at the NAV of next Business Day after the Record Date.

The IDCW payout shall be subject to the availability of distributable surplus and if the available distributable surplus as on the Record Date is lower than the abovementioned IDCW rate, then the available distributable surplus shall be paid out. The payout shall be subject to tax deducted at source i.e. TDS, as applicable.

For Quantum Asset Management Company Private Limited
(Investment Manager - Quantum Mutual Fund)
Sd/-
Seemant Shukla
Chief Executive Officer

Place: Mumbai
Date: September 11, 2026

Mutual Fund investments are subject to market risks, read all scheme related documents carefully.

KS SMART TECHNOLOGIES LIMITED
(Formerly known as Soma Papers & Industries Limited)
Corporate Identity Number: L62099TN1991PLC196352
Registered Office: 528, Anna Salai, Teynampet, Chennai, Tamil Nadu, 600018
Tel No: 72003 94611 | Website: <https://ksstech.co> | Email ID: secretarial@ksmart.co

NOTICE OF POSTAL BALLOT

Members are hereby informed that pursuant to provisions of Section 108 and Section 110 and other applicable provisions, if any, of the Companies Act, 2013 ("the Act") read with Rule 20 and Rule 22 of Companies (Management and Administration) Rules, 2014, as amended, read with the General Circular Nos. 14/2020 dated 8th April, 2020 and 17/2020 dated 13th April, 2020 read with other relevant circulars, including General Circular No. 03/2025 dated 22nd September, 2025 issued by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs ("MCA Circulars"), and Regulation 44 of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015, ("Listing Regulations") (including any statutory modification(s) or re-enactment(s) thereof for the time being in force and as amended from time to time), the Postal Ballot Notice along with the Explanatory Statement has been sent to electronically on Friday, September 11, 2026 to all Members of the Company, whose email IDs are registered with the Company/Registrar/Depositories as on Friday, September 04, 2026 ("cut-off date") for seeking the approval of the members, in respect of the ordinary / Special Resolutions by voting through electronic means ("remote e-voting") on the following matters:

Sl. No.	Particulars
1.	To increase In Authorised Share Capital & Consequent Alteration of MOA.
2.	To increase In Investment Limits for Foreign Portfolio Investors and Non-Resident Indians/ Overseas Citizens of India.
3.	To approve raising of Funds and Issuance of Securities through QIP and/or FCCB and/or any other permissible modes.

The said Notice is available on the Company's website <https://ksstech.co/investors> and on the website of BSE Limited www.bseindia.com and on the website of National Securities Depository Limited www.evoting.nsdl.com. The Company has appointed National Securities Depository Limited (NSDL) to facilitate e-voting for enabling Members to cast their votes electronically. Members can vote on the resolutions through e-voting only. The e-voting period will commence on Saturday, September 12, 2026 at 9:00 AM IST and conclude on Sunday, October 11, 2026 at 5:00 P.M. IST. The e-voting module shall thereafter be disabled by NSDL.

In accordance with the MCA Circulars, Members may vote only through the remote e-voting process. Members whose names appear on the Register of Members/List of Beneficial Owners as on Friday, September 04, 2026 shall be eligible to vote, and voting rights will be reckoned based on the paid-up value of equity shares held as on that date. A person who is not a member as on the cut-off date should treat this Notice for communication purposes only. Physical copies of the Notice, postal ballot forms, and pre-paid Business Reply Envelopes are not being sent, and Members are requested to record their assent or dissent through e-voting only.

The Board of Directors appointed CS Nuren Lodaya, Proprietor of M/s Nuren Lodaya & Associates, Practicing Company Secretaries as the Scrutinizer for conducting the postal ballot through the e-voting process in a fair and transparent manner. The results declared along with the Scrutinizer's report shall be communicated to the stock exchange and will also be displayed on the Company's and NSDL website within two working days from the conclusion of remote e-voting.

Members holding shares in physical form and who have not updated their email address are requested to update the same by writing to the Company's RTA with a signed request letter mentioning their name and address, along with self-attested copies of their PAN card and valid address proof (Driving License/Election ID/Passport). Members holding shares in dematerialised form are requested to update their email address with their respective Depository Participants. For any queries or assistance, Members may write to secretarial@ksmart.co.

In case of any query pertaining to e-voting, you may call on Toll Free No.: 022-4886 7000 or send a request at evoting@nsdl.co.in

For KS Smart Technologies Limited
(Formerly known as Soma Papers and Industries Limited)
SD/-
Priyanka Malpani
Company Secretary & Compliance Officer
A64349

Date: 11.09.2026
Place: Chennai

"IMPORTANT"

Whilst care is taken prior to acceptance of advertising copy, it is not possible to verify its contents. The Indian Express (P) Limited cannot be held responsible for such contents, nor for any loss or damage incurred as a result of transactions with companies, associations or individuals adversing in its newspapers or Publications. We therefore recommend that readers make necessary inquiries before sending any monies or entering into any agreements with advertisers or otherwise acting on an advertisement in any manner whatsoever.

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I look at every side before taking a side.

Inform your opinion with insightful perspectives.

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BENGALURU

L&T Finance Limited
Registered Office: L&T Finance Limited, Brindavan Building
Plot No. 177, Kalina, CST Road, Near Mercedes Showroom
Santacruz (East), Mumbai 400 098
CIN No.: L67120MH2008PLC181833
Branch office: Bangalore



DEMAND NOTICE

Under Section 13(2) of Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets & Enforcement of Security Interest Act 2002 (Herein after referred to as The Act)

We have issued Demand Notice under Section 13(2) of the Act to you all (Borrower/s, Co-borrower/s & Guarantor/s) through Registered Post Acknowledge Due, as you have defaulted in payment of interest and principal installments of your loan account, and have failed and neglected to clear the said outstanding dues. As a result, the loan account has been classified as Non-Performing Asset (NPA) in the book of account in accordance with the directives relating to asset classification issued by the Reserve Bank of India. The Notice has been returned as "undelivered" and therefore we are now issuing this notice to you all under 13(2) of the Act and hereby calling upon to repay the amount mentioned in the notice appended below to the L&T Finance Limited. Within the period of 60 Days from the date of this Paper Notification together with further interest and other charges from the date of Demand Notice till payment or realization. In case you are not discharging your liabilities under the terms of this notice, we shall be constrained to exercise all or any one of the rights conferred under Section 13(4) or Section 14 of the Act. "This is without prejudice to any rights available to us under the Act and/or any other law in force from time to time."

Loan Account Number	Borrower/s & Co-borrower/s Name	Demand Notice date / NPA date / Outstanding Amount (₹) As On		Description of the Immovable Property (Mortgaged)
		NPA Date	Outstanding Amount (₹) As On	
H00254110 122063711, H00254110 122063711 G.H002541 101220637 11L	1. Saurabh Sanyasi	Demand Notice Date: 03.09.2026 NPA Date: 01/09/2026	Rs. 7324877.08/- (Rupees Seventy-Three Lakh Twenty-Four Thousand Eight Hundred Eighty Seven and Eight Paise Only) As On Date 02/09/2026	Schedule - I Residential Apartment Bearing No. 14102, Situated On 10th Floor, Tower No 14, Building No. 1a In "Prestige Finsbury Park - Regent", Property, Measuring 1045 Sq. Ft. Of Carpet Area And 1473 Sq. Ft. Of Super Built Up Area, (Inclusive Of Proportionate Share In All The Common Areas Such As Passages, Lobbies, Lifts, Staircases And Other Areas Of Common Use) And With One Car Parking Space In The Basement Or Without Car Parking Space Along With 1473/1326236TH Undivided Right, Title And Interest And Ownership In Plot No. R-6-part-1 Of Hardware Sector At Hitech, Defence & Aerospace Park, Bengaluru, Comprised In Sy. No. Parts Of 429 & 462, Within The Village Limits Of Bagalur Village, Jala Hobli, Bengaluru North Yelahanka Taluk, Bengaluru Urban District, Containing By Admeasurement 40470.00 Sqr. Mtrs. Or Thereabouts.

Date: 12.09.2026
Place: Bangalore

Sd/-
Authorized Officer
For L&T FINANCE LIMITED



Asset Reconstruction Company (India) Ltd. (Arcil)

Acting in its capacity as Trustee of various Arcil Trusts
Arcil office : The Ruby, 10th floor, 29, Senapati Bapat Marg, Dadar (West) Mumbai-400 028.
Website: <https://auction.arcil.co.in>; CIN: U65999MH2002PLC134884

PUBLIC NOTICE FOR SALE THROUGH ONLINE E-AUCTION IN EXERCISE OF THE POWERS UNDER THE SECURITISATION AND RECONSTRUCTION OF FINANCIAL ASSETS AND ENFORCEMENT OF SECURITY INTEREST ACT, 2002 (SARFAESI ACT) READ WITH RULES 6, 8 & 9 OF SECURITY INTEREST (ENFORCEMENT) RULES, 2002

Notice is hereby given to the public in general and to the Borrower (s) / Guarantor (s) / Mortgagee (s), in particular, that the below described immovable properties mortgaged/charged to the Asset Reconstruction Company (India) Limited, acting in its capacity as Trustee of various Arcil Trusts ("ARCIL") (pursuant to the assignment of financial asset vide registered Assignment Agreements), will be sold on "As is where is", "As is what is", "Whatever there is" and "Without recourse basis" by way of online e-auction, for recovery of outstanding dues together with further interest, charges and costs etc., as detailed below in terms of the provisions of the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 ("Act") read with Rules 6, 8 and 9 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 ("Rules").

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower / Co-Borrower/s/Guarantor/s Mortgagee/s	LAN No. & Selling Bank	Trust Name	Outstanding amount as per SARFAESI Notice dated 27-01-2026 respectively	Possession type and date	Date of Inspection	Type of Property	Earnest Money Deposit (EMD)	Reserve Price	Date & Time of E-Auction
1. Borrower:	Mr/Mrs.Gundaiah D Mr/Mrs.Kalavathi M	Loan Account Nos. HLO5LAN00009414 Cholamandalam Investment and Finance Company Limited	Arcil - Trust - 2026 - 013	Rs. 1214784/- (Rupees Twelve lakhs Fourteen Thousand Seven Hundred Eighty Four Only as on 22-01-2026 + further Interest thereon + Legal Expenses)	Symbolic possession on 21-08-2026	Will be arranged on request	INDIVIDUAL HOUSE 1306 Sq.ft.	Rs. 136106.30 (Rupees One Lakh Thirty Six Thousand One Hundred Six and Thirty Paise)	Rs. 1361063/- (Rupees Thirteen Lakh Sixty One Thousand Sixty Three Only)	16-10-2026 1:00:00 PM
Description of the Secured Asset being auctioned : All the piece and parcel of the property bearing kaneshmari E katha No.152900201100620014, measuring East to West 10.67 Mtrs and North to South 10.67 Mtrs, in all measuring 113.81 sq.mtrs., situated at Chaakanahalli Village, Chaakanahalli Grama Panchayath, Kasaba Hobli, Kanakapura Taluk, Ramanagara District and bounded on : East by: Shivappa Property, West by: Government Road, North by: Muddegowda property, and South by: Kanyappa's House.										
2. Borrower:	Mr/Mrs.SHIVARAMU NAVEEN KUMAR Mr/Mrs.NAGENDRA DHANALAKSHMI Mr/Mrs. LAKSHMAMMA	Loan Account Nos. HLO5LAN000028146 Cholamandalam Investment and Finance Company Limited	Arcil - Trust - 2026 - 013	Rs. 1818265/- (Rupees Eighteen lakhs Eighteen Thousand Two Hundred Sixty Five Only as on 22-01-2026 + further Interest thereon + Legal Expenses)	Symbolic possession on 20-08-2026	Will be arranged on request	INDIVIDUAL HOUSE 1746 Sq.ft.	Rs. 383586.30 (Rupees Three Lakh Eighty Three Thousand Five Hundred Eighty Six and Thirty Paise)	Rs. 3835863/- (Rupees Thirteen Lakh Thirty Five Thousand Eight Hundred Sixty Three Only)	16-10-2026 1:00:00 PM
Description of the Secured Asset being auctioned : All the piece and parcel of the property bearing No.342 and E Katha (PID No) No.152900201000200551 situated at Kurubarahalli Village, Choodahalli Grama Panchayath, Kanakapura Taluk and Ramanagara District., measuring East to West 27.43 Mtr, and North to South 11.89 Mtr in all measuring 326.99 Sq.Mtr., and consisting building measuring 71.07 sq.mtr and bounded on : East by: Property of K.V Venkateswara, West by: House of Ramesh and South by: House of Shivanduriah.										
3. Borrower:	Mr/Mrs.SHIVAIAH Mr/Mrs.Jayamma S	Loan Account Nos. HLO5BNA000046311 Cholamandalam Investment and Finance Company Limited	Arcil - Trust - 2026 - 013	Rs. 1539546/- (Rupees Fifteen lakhs Thirty Nine Thousand Five Hundred Forty Six Only as on 22-01-2026 + further Interest thereon + Legal Expenses)	Symbolic possession on 20-08-2026	Will be arranged on request	INDIVIDUAL HOUSE 550 Sq.ft.	Rs. 156327.80 (Rupees One Lakh Fifty Six Thousand Three Hundred Twenty Seven and Eighty Paise)	Rs. 1563278/- (Rupees Fifteen Lakh Sixty Three Thousand Two Hundred Seventy Eight Only)	16-10-2026 1:00:00 PM
Description of the Secured Asset being auctioned : All the piece and parcel of the property bearing No.94/81 and E Katha No. 152900203300800081, situated at Athihalli Village, Arekattedoddi Grama panchayath, Kanakapura Taluk, and Ramanagara Dist., measuring East to West 11.27760 meters and North to South 15.5448 meters totally measuring 175.30 sq.meters along with building constructed thereon and bounded on East by : Site of applicant, West by: House of C. Chandregowda, North by: Govt. Road, South by: Site of applicant.										
4. Borrower:	Mr/Mrs.KEMMALE BASAVARAJU GOWDA UMADEVI Mr/Mrs.SHEKHAR Mr/Mrs. DARSHAN S	Loan Account Nos. HLO5BNA000037796 Cholamandalam Investment and Finance Company Limited	Arcil - Trust - 2026 - 013	Rs. 18269567/- (Rupees Eighteen lakhs Sixty Nine Thousand Five Hundred Sixty Seven Only as on 22-01-2026 + further Interest thereon + Legal Expenses)	Symbolic possession on 20-08-2026	Will be arranged on request	INDIVIDUAL HOUSE 731 Sq.ft.	Rs. 193987/- (Rupees One Lakh Ninety Three Thousand Nine Hundred Eighty Seven Only)	Rs. 1939870/- (Rupees Nineteen Lakh Thirty Nine Thousand Eight Hundred Seventy Only)	16-10-2026 1:00:00 PM
Description of the Secured Asset being auctioned : All the piece and parcel of the property bearing No. 122/ 43/2 and E Katha (PID No) 152900204000220113 measuring East to West 7.40 + 6.40/2 = 6.90 Mtr and North to South 28.00+28.00/2 =28.00 Mtr in total measuring 193.20 Sq.mtr, situated at Kemmelle Village, Honniganahalli Panchayath, Kanakapura Taluk and Ramanagara District and bounded on : East by : Property of Basavaraju, West by : Property of Puttaswamy, North by : own Property and South by : Road.										
5. Borrower:	Mr/Mrs.MUTHTHURAJU Mr/Mrs.KANCHANA	Loan Account Nos. HLO5AMN000046830 Cholamandalam Investment and Finance Company Limited	Arcil - Trust - 2026 - 013	Rs. 18269567/- (Rupees Eighteen lakhs Twenty Five Thousand Nine Hundred Eighty Nine Only as on 22-01-2026 + further Interest thereon + Legal Expenses)	Symbolic possession on 20-08-2026	Will be arranged on request	INDIVIDUAL HOUSE 1250 Sq.ft.	Rs. 415949.07 (Rupees Four Lakh Fifteen Thousand Nine Hundred Forty Nine and Seven Paise)	Rs. 4159490.74 (Rupees Forty One Lakh Fifty Nine Thousand Four Hundred Ninety and Seventy Four Paise)	16-10-2026 1:00:00 PM
Description of the Secured Asset being auctioned : All the piece and parcel of the property bearing No.6/6/3 and E Katha No. 152900100300400006 situated at Hunasanahalli Village, Kodamballi Grama Panchayath, Virupakshipura Hobli, Channapattana Taluk, and Ramanagara Dist., measuring 390.19 Sq.mtr with 111.48 Sq.mtr RCC building and bounded on : East by : House of Dasegowda , West by : House of Poojari Doddathammaiah , North by : Road, South by : Property of Sannou										

Pending Litigations known to ARCIL	NIL	Encumbrances/Dues known to ARCIL	Nil
Last Date for submission of Bid	One day before auction date	Bid Increment amount	As mentioned in the BID document
Demand Draft to be made in name of:	Arcil-Trust-2026-013	Payable at par	
RTGS details	Arcil-Trust-2026-013, Trust account No - 57500001796433, HDFC Bank limited, Branch: MUMBAI - KAMALA MILLS, IFSC Code: HDFC0000542	Name of Contact person & number	MR Ravikiran .9742449049, ravikiran@chola.murugappa.com MR Mahantesh Hullar .9731219256, mahanteshu@chola.murugappa.com MR.wasim.sayed .022-66581376, collections8@arcil.co.in

Terms and Conditions :

- The Auction Sale is being conducted through e-auction through the website <https://auction.arcil.co.in> and as per the Terms and Conditions of the Bid Document, and as per the procedure set out therein.
- The Authorized Officer ("AO")/ARCIL shall not be held responsible for internet connectivity, network problems, system crash down, power failure etc.
- At any stage of the auction, the AO may accept/reject/modify/cancel the bid offer or post-pones the Auction without assigning any reason thereof and without any prior notice.
- The successful purchaser/bidder shall bear any statutory dues, taxes, fees payable, applicable GST on the purchase consideration, stamp duty, registration fees, etc. that is required to be paid in order to get the secured asset conveyed/delivered in his/her favour as per the applicable law.
- The intending bidders should make their own independent enquiries/ due diligence regarding encumbrances, title of secured asset and claims/rights/dues affecting the secured assets, including statutory dues, etc., prior to submitting their bid. The auction advertisement does not constitute and will not constitute any commitment or any representation of ARCIL. The Authorized Officer of ARCIL shall not be responsible in any way for any third-party claims/rights/dues.
- The particulars specified in the auction notice published in the newspaper have been stated to the best of the information of the undersigned; however, undersigned shall not be responsible / liable for any error, misstatement or omission.
- The Borrower/ Guarantors/ Mortgagees, who are liable for the said outstanding dues, shall treat this Sale Notice as a notice under Rules 8 and 9 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, about the holding of the above-mentioned auction sale.
- In the event, the auction scheduled hereinabove fails for any reason whatsoever, ARCIL has the right to sell the secured asset by any other methods under the provisions of Rule 8(5) of the Rules and the Act.

Place : Kanakapura - Ramanagara | Date : 07-09-2026 Sd/- Authorized Officer Asset Reconstruction Company (India) Ltd. (Trustee of Arcil-Trust-2026-013)

BAJAJ HOUSING FINANCE LIMITED

Corporate office: Cerebrum IT Park B2 Building 5th Floor, Kalyani Nagar, Pune, Maharashtra-411014. Branch Office: Bajaj Housing Finance Limited, 1st & 2nd floor, JK Towers, 719/A-53-2, 46th Cross, Sangam circle, Jayanagar, Above More outlet, 8th Block, Bangalore 560082

POSSESSION NOTICE

U/s 13(4) of the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002. Rule 8(1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002. (Appendix-IV)

Whereas, the undersigned being the Authorized Officer of M/s BAJAJ HOUSING FINANCE LIMITED (BHFL) under the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act 2002 and in exercise of powers conferred under section 13(2) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002, issued Demand Notice(s) to Borrower(s)/Co-Borrower(s)/ Guarantor(s) mentioned herein below to repay the amount mentioned in the notice within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said notice. The Borrower(s)/ Co-Borrower(s)/ Guarantor(s) having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the Borrower(s)/ Co-Borrower(s)/ Guarantor(s) and the public in general that the undersigned on behalf of M/s Bajaj Housing Finance Limited, has taken over the possession of the property described herein below in exercise of the powers conferred on him under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8(1) of the said rules. The Borrower(s)/ Co-Borrower(s)/ Guarantor(s) in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with the below said property and any dealings with the said property will be subject to the first charge of BHFL for the amount(s) as mentioned herein under with future interest thereon.

Name of the Borrower(s) / Guarantor (s) (LAN No., Name of Branch)	Description of Secured Asset (Immovable Property)	Demand Notice Date and Amount	Date of Possession
Branch : BANGALORE, LAN: H404HLT1553449 and H404HHL1539334, 1. Sreyas Bhattacharjee (Borrower), At No 2nd Floor Praise Cottage 10th Cross, Thigalarapalya Road Ramiah Reddy Layout, Bangalore, Karnataka-560048. 2. Swapan Bhattacharjee (Co-Borrower), At No 2nd Floor Praise Cottage 10th Cross, Thigalarapalya Road Ramiah Reddy Layout, Bangalore, Karnataka-560048. 3. Diya Bhattacharjee (Co-Borrower), At No 2nd Floor Praise Cottage 10th Cross, Thigalarapalya Road Ramiah Reddy Layout, Bangalore, Karnataka-560048.	Schedule Of Property: Schedule "A": All That Piece And Parcel Of The Non-Agricultural Property Described As: All That Piece And Parcel Of The Immovable Property Bearing Residential Vacant Site No.1, Old B.B.M.P.K Khattha No.1030/29, New No.252/1030/29, 172, Site No.01, (Carved Out Converted Sy.No.172, Converted From Agricultural To Non-Agricultural Residential Memorandum Bearing No.ALNEKHVWSR/13/2011-12 Dated 07/07/2011 Issued By The Office Of The Deputy Commissioner, Bangalore District, Bangalore) Measuring East To West 40 Feet And North To South (48 Feet + 53 Feet)2, Totally Measuring 2020 Sq.Feet Situated At Hagdur Village, K.R.Puram Hobli, Bangalore East Taluk, Ward No.84, Bangalore And Bounded On The: East By: Private Property, West By: Road, North By: Private Property, South By: Site Bearing No.2, Schedule "B": 204.410 Sq Ft Undivided Right, Title And Interest In The Immovable Property Mentioned In Schedule "A" Above. Schedule "C": Flat Bearing No.202, In The Second Floor, Measuring About 1060 Sq.Ft. Super Built Up Area, Containing Two Bed Rooms, Together With RCC Roofing, Ventilated Flooring Together With Adjustment One Covered Car Parking Space, Including Proportionate Share In Common Areas Such As Passages, Lobbies, Staircase, Etc. In The Multistored Residential Building Complex Known As "NAGOLU RESIDENCY" Constructed Over Schedule "A" Property.	14th Apr 2026 Rs. 63,25,394/- (Rupees Sixty Three Lakh Twenty Five Thousand Three Hundred Ninety Four Only)	07-Sep-26

Symbolic Possession Date: 07-Sep-26, Place: Bangalore Sd/- Authorised Officer, Bajaj Housing Finance Limited

VASTU HOUSING FINANCE CORPORATION LTD

Unit 203 & 204, 2nd Floor, "A" Wing, Navbharat Estate, Zakaria Bunder Road, Sewri (West), Mumbai 400015, Maharashtra.

CIN No.: U65922MH2005PLC272501

POSSESSION NOTICE

Whereas, The undersigned being the Authorised Officer of Vastu Housing Finance Corporation Limited under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of powers conferred to him under section 13 (12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002, issued a Demand Notice calling upon the borrowers mentioned herein below to repay the amount mentioned in the respective notice within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said notice. The borrowers having failed to repay the amount, undersigned has taken possession of the property described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on me under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said rules on the date mentioned below. The borrower and guarantor in particular and the public in general is hereby cautioned not to deal with the property and any dealings with the property will be subject to the charge of the Vastu Housing Finance Corporation Limited Branch for an amount mentioned as below and interest thereon, costs etc.

S N	Name of Borrower, Co-Borrower and LAN No.	Date & Amount of Demand Notice	Description of Property	Date & Type of Possession
1	Roopa R (Borrower) , Parashurama B (Co Borrower), Venkatappa B (Co Borrower) HL0000000112958	17/Jun/26 Rs.487015/- as on 16/Jun/26	All that part and parcel of the Immovable property situated at All the piece and parcel of the Property/Khattha No.455, (as per Grama Panchayath Records), PID No.151200600100220067, Situated at Ujappavaderahalli Village and Didigidi Village Panchayath, Jagalur Taluk, Davangere District., Karnataka 577513 measuring East To West:6.4008 meters and North to South:12.8016 meters, In all totally measuring 81.94 Sq.meters, alongwith building thereon, Boundaries as follows: North – Banni mahakali devi temple South – Road East – Property Belongs to Mrs.Annkamma West – Property Belongs to Mr.Murthappa	Symbolic Possession Taken 07/09/2026
2	All the legal heirs of borrower Shivraju B (since deceased), namely Jyothi S (wife) (Legal Heir of Late Shivraju B), Akasha S (Son) (Legal Heir of Late Shivraju B), co-borrower(s): Akasha S, Jyothi HL0000000157052	26/May/26 Rs.223830/- as on 12/May/26	All that part and parcel of the Immovable property situated at All that piece and parcel of the Residential Property bearing No. 666/495, (as per E Katha Bearing Form No. 9 and 11A), Property Unique No. 152100303400100902, Measuring East to West 12.192 Meters, and North to South 9.144 Meters, totally measuring 111.48 Sq. Meters., situated at B.G.Pura Grama Panchayath, Malavalli, Mandya District., Karnataka, 571417 Boundaries as follows: North – Site belongs to Puttana, South – House belongs to Shivraju East – Road West – Site belongs to Mahadevappa	Symbolic Possession Taken 07/09/2026
3	Ravi N (Borrower) , B Rudramma, (Co Borrower), Kavya H P (Co Borrower) LP0000000092623	17/Jun/26 Rs.444213/- as on 16/Jun/26	All that part and parcel of the Immovable property situated at All that piece and parcel of the Property No.53(as per Grama Panchayath Records), PID No.151200201900300056, Situated at Bhavhal Village, Davangere Taluk, Davangere District, comes under the Limits of Naraganahalli village Panchayat, along with House Constructed thereon, measuring East to West 7.9248 meters and North to South 10.97 meters, In all totally measuring 86.95 Sq.meters, Karnataka- 577534 Boundaries as follows: North – Property Belongs to H Kallappa, South – Road, East – Well, West – Property Belongs to Marulayya,	Symbolic Possession Taken 07/09/2026
4	Kumar M P (Borrower) , Gowramma P (Co Borrower) LP0000000119461	17/Jun/26 Rs.624225/- as on 16/Jun/26	All that part and parcel of the Immovable property situated at All that Piece and parcel for Property bearing No.324/226, (as per Gram Panchayath records) PID No. 152900102301200447, Situated at: Molledoddi Village (Sanabahalhi Dhakle), Neelasaandra Grama Panchayath, Channapattana Taluk, Ramanagara District, measuring East to West: 9.144 Mtrs., and North to South: 20.7264 Mtrs., totally measuring 189.52 Sq.Mtrs., along with 189.52 Sq.Mtrs., of building constructed thereon, karantaka-562160 Boundaries as follows: North – House belongs to Dasalah Hanumantha, South – Wide Road, East – House belongs to Avalli Bettiah, West – House belongs to Govindiah	Symbolic Possession Taken 08/09/2026
5	Rangappa H N (Borrower) , Mamatha R (Co Borrower), Nagendrapa R (Co Borrower), Savitramma N (Co Borrower) MLP0000000245481	17/Jun/26 Rs.635731/- as on 16/Jun/26	All that part and parcel of the Immovable property situated at All that Piece and Parcel of Property bearing No.34, PID No. 151200301700300510(As Per Grama Panchayath Records), Situated at Hindasagatta Village, Vasana Grama Panchayath, Harihar taluk, Davangere District, Measuring East to West: 9.144Meters and North to South: 12.192 Meters, Totally measuring 111.483648 Sq. Meters, along with Building constructed measuring 111.483648 Sq Meters, thereon and Bounded on the: Boundaries as follows: North – Agricultural land South – Road East – Site No 35 West – Site No 33	Symbolic Possession Taken 08/09/2026
6	Shabbir A (Borrower) , Zareen Taj (Co Borrower) HL0000000117256 LP0000000111807	17/Jun/26 Rs.754263/- as on 16/Jun/26	All that piece and parcel of the immovable property bearing current katha No. 255/221 situated at Kote Extension, ward No. 14/3, Kunigal Town, under the Kunigal Municipal Council, Kunigal. As per partition deed measuring East West: 32 3/4 feet and North South : 27 feet out of which East West: 32 3/4 feet and North South : 17 1/4 feet., Tumkur, Karnataka, 572130 Boundaries as follows: North – Conservancy and House of Mohamood Sult – Conservancy East – Municipal Road, West – Property of Imran	Symbolic Possession Taken 08/09/2026
7	Shankar TK (Borrower) , Nagastree TR (Co Borrower), Asha HM (Co Borrower), Asha HM (Co Borrower), Shobha T K (Co Borrower) LP0000000131824	17/Jun/26 Rs.566754/- as on 16/Jun/26	All that part and parcel of the Immovable property situated at All the piece and parcel of the Property No.2324, Site No.15 and 16, Sy. No.30, Ward No.30, PID J k e., No.48382 (as per CMC Records), Situated at Shethihalli Village Now Comes under CMC limit, Saphthigiri La Tumkur Town, Tumkur Taluk, Tumkur District, Measuring East to West:20 Feet and North to South:20 feet, in all totally measuring 580 Sq.feet constructed there on, Karnataka-572102 Boundaries as follows: North – Private Property, South – Path Way, East – Property Belongs to Papahli, West – Road;	Symbolic Possession Taken 07/09/2026
8	Kiran S G (Borrower) , Govindaraju N (Co Borrower), Rathnamma T (Co Borrower) LP0000000149756	17/Jun/26 Rs.945134/- as on 16/Jun/26	All that part and parcel of the Immovable property situated at All the Piece and parcel of the property No.149, (As Per Grama Panchayath Records), PID No.152500201900900184, Formed in Sy.No.134/3B, Situated at:Singonahalli Village, Adaguru Gram Panchayath, Gubbi Taluk, Tumkur District, Measuring East to West :15.243 Mtrs, and North to South: 12.195 Mtrs, in all totally measuring 185.81 Sq.Mtrs, Along with 81.29 Sq.Mtrs, building constructed thereon, and Bounded On: Boundaries as follows: North – Gali South – Road East – Remaining B H Road West – Remaining	Symbolic Possession Taken 07/09/2026
9	Satyajit Dey (Borrower) , Tiyaasha Software Private Limited (Co Borrower), Tiyaasha Mondal (Co Borrower) HL0000000109316	17/Jun/26 Rs.5180671/- as on 16/Jun/26	All that part and parcel of the Immovable property situated at All that piece and parcel of residentially converted lands bearing New Survey Numbers 1 to 26 of Venkatapura Village, Kengeri Hobli, Bangalore South Taluk (presently under H. Gollahalli Grampanchayat having katha No. 150200302601000009) measuring in all about 51 Acres 9.6 Guntas out of which 3008 Sq. Meter equivalent to 32.378 Sq. ft have been relinquished for putting up electrical sub-station area and 96145.67 Sq.ft have been reserved towards Civic amenities. An undivided 0.018% (Zero Point Zero one eight percent) share (equivalent to 383.69 Square feet) in the land comprised in the Schedule A Property, Bangalore South, Karnataka, 560060 Boundaries as follows: North – Doddabale Village Boundary South – Yrshabhavalli Valley / stream and private property East – 3 Meters Access Road and thereafter Doddabale Village Boundary West – Kambipura Village Boundary	Symbolic Possession Taken 08/09/2026
10	K Swamy Deva (Borrower) , Gangamma K (Co Borrower) LP0000000163088	23/Jul/25 Rs.518595/- as on 9/Jul/25	All that part and parcel of the Immovable property situated at All that piece and parcel of the immovable Property bearing No.154, (As per the Grama Panchayath Limits) PID.No.151200600300720029, formed in Sy.No.7, Situated at: Vyasagondanahalli Village, Bishthuvalli Grama Panchayath, Jagalur Taluk, Davangere District, Measuring East to West: 9.14 Mtrs., North to South: 6.10 Mtrs., in all totally measuring 55.80 Sq.Mtrs., along with 55.80 Sq.Mtrs., building construction thereon, and bounded on:- Boundaries as follows: North – House belongs to Manjamma, South – Road East – House belongs to Nagaraju, West – Property	Physical Possession Taken 10/09/2026

Date : 12.09.2026 Place : Mysore, Tumkur, Davangere, Bengaluru, Shivamoga, Channapattana Authorised officer Vastu Housing Finance Corporation Ltd

Technology service firms set to gain as MDR returns to UPI

ANEEES HUSSAIN
Mumbai, September 11

BANKS AND PAYMENT apps may split the merchant discount rate (MDR) set to return on UPI, but the first to benefit could be the companies that build their payment systems.

Technology service providers (TSPs), which build UPI switches, card platforms and payment apps, are already seeing an influx of enquiries from banks and non-banking financial companies (NBFCs) looking to launch their own third-party application provider (TPAP) apps, the consumer-facing UPI apps such as PhonePe and Google Pay, according to multiple industry executives *FE* spoke to.

The layer includes Mindgate Solutions, NPST, Sarvatra Technologies, Juspay, M2P Fintech, Zeta, iServeU and Finarkein Analytics.

MDR, the fee a merchant pays for accepting digital payments, has been zero on UPI since January 2020, when the government barred banks and payment firms from charging it. In effect, banks and apps have earned nothing from merchant payments on UPI for six years, beyond a government incentive for low-value payments at small merchants.

The government is now reportedly working on a structure under which it would be shared among banks, UPI apps and other players.

It would apply only to larger merchants and higher-value payments, while person-to-person transfers stay free.

Once they can earn from UPI, banks and apps are expected to turn more aggressive on it.

The fee is unlikely to be a

TECH WINDFALL

■ TSPs seeing influx of enquiries from banks and NBFCs looking to launch their own third-party application provider apps

■ MDR, the fee a merchant pays for accepting digital payments, has been zero on UPI since January 2020

■ Govt reportedly working on a structure under which MDR would be shared among banks, UPI apps and other players

blanket charge. Merchants could be classified by business category, much as GST treats essential and non-essential goods differently, the founder and CEO of a top UPI app told *FE*.

Either way, banks will need to establish which merchants qualify for which rate.

That first layer of work is especially tricky for merchants who bank with several lenders, said Nikhil Kurhe, co-founder and CEO of Finarkein Analytics, a Pune-based TSP that builds data infrastructure for financial institutions.

He expects merchants to bear the burden of proving they qualify for a lower MDR, much like lower-TDS certificates.

“Since our customers tend to be the larger regulated entities and we are not in the business of direct merchant acquisition, we will bill the regulated entities,” Kurhe said. Banks and acquirers would then decide whether to pass on the cost or absorb it.

Much of the demand is for apps. Devi Prasanna Pradhan, head of marketing at iServeU, a

Bhubaneswar-based TSP that builds payments and card infrastructure for banks and NBFCs, said the company is getting a heavy influx of requests to build third-party application provider (TPAP) apps, consumer-facing UPI apps like PhonePe and Google Pay.

An NBFC’s borrowers pay EMIs through apps such as PhonePe today, but the lender could offer that on its own app.

“Since there is no MDR, there is no way of making money,” Pradhan said. “But now, there are many players who want their TPAP apps, and we are getting a serious number of enquiries.” iServeU can build one within 30 days of signing, excluding NPCI certification, he added.

Siddharth Mehta, co-founder of Kiwi, a fintech offering credit on UPI, said MDR will boost investor confidence in the sector.

“Till now, the investor perception was that you bring customers, you create engagement, and then you cross-sell,” he said. “Now at least the core economics will work.”

From Maggi noodles to Thums Up: How India became dependent on cheap packaged food

RICHA NAIDU & ADITYA KALRA
London/New Delhi, September 11

THE GOVERNMENT’S PROPOSAL to put health warning labels on some food products has sparked a nationwide debate over how the country came to rely on cheap packaged food while companies sold more nutritious versions of the same brands in other markets.

With an income per household well below the global average, Indians are keen consumers of cheap food products such as Nestle-owned Maggi instant noodles and Coca-Cola’s Thums Up — giving big food manufacturers a huge market with little pressure to apply the food standards they adopt in many other countries.

In a setback to the industry, the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) said on Thursday it could introduce tougher red warning labels on food that exceeds government-set limits on added sugar, salt or saturated fat in one go, after Supreme Court judges raised questions about FSSAI’s initial plan for a phased introduction.

High sugar content is a particular risk in India, which accounts for about a quarter of all global cases of diabetes, which health experts have blamed partly on processed



food. More than 101 million people in India are living with diabetes, while another 136 million have prediabetes, Danish drugmaker Novo Nordisk said in July.

Fast-growing market

The country’s packaged food market grew to \$137.25 billion in 2026, from \$129.18 billion in 2025, and is projected to reach \$238.83 billion by 2034, according to research firm IMARC Group.

Around 6 billion meals eaten in local households and on street corners every year are Maggi two-minute masala noodles, made by Swiss food giant Nestle.

Maggi launched the nation’s first brand of instant noodles in

1983, targeting newly working mothers and children as a fast evening snack with print ads featuring kids slurping bowls of Maggi noodles “after school, after play” and saying “Mummy, I’m hungry.”

The product’s success strengthened Nestle’s foothold in what is today the company’s fastest-growing region, where all variants of Maggi are made with palm oil, whereas many versions sold in Britain use pricier sunflower oil. Similarly, Nestle’s KitKat bars in India have less cocoa in them than Australian versions.

“It plays on national pride — why is it that India is getting short-changed? Why do companies make the call on my behalf that I can’t afford better ingre-

dients?” said Shashank Mehta, a former marketing manager at Unilever’s India unit.

Higher quality ingredients are also more expensive and could prompt price hikes in a cost-conscious market, a former senior Nestle executive, who declined to be named, said. Nestle said in a statement that its recipes are developed taking into account consumer expectations, local taste preferences depending on the food culture, availability of ingredients and climatic conditions.

Recipe variations do not affect product quality, Nestle said, adding that it has more than 10 regional KitKat recipes globally. The company said it complies with all Indian food safety laws and that ingredients

are clearly declared on packs.

Public anger

India has debated front-of-pack warning labels for years to flag high content of sugar, salt and fat, like those implemented in Chile and Mexico, but faced industry opposition, with businesses specifically worried as many traditional Indian products are high in sugar or fat.

Chile’s 2016 food labelling law, which puts separate black octagons on a pack for each high nutrient, was followed by a 23.7% decline in purchases of sugary drinks, researchers have said.

The All India Food Processors’ Association says 80% of packaged food could be flagged in India as having high fat, sugar or salt content under the proposed labelling rule.

Pressure in India for stricter labelling has intensified recently from health advocates and social media influencers among others.

The food safety regulator’s proposal came amid public anger after Reuters reported that India’s government had yielded to industry lobbying in March when Coca-Cola and groups backing Nestle and PepsiCo opposed having warning labels on the front of food and drinks packaging.

—REUTERS

Freight corridors, logistics parks could save ₹7L cr: IIM Mumbai

MANU KAUSHIK
New Delhi, September 11

THE DEDICATED FREIGHT corridors (DFCs) and multimodal logistics parks (MMLPs) could help cut India’s logistics cost by nearly ₹7 lakh crore annually and create close to 10 million jobs, IIM Mumbai has estimated.

The two mega-projects can help connect rail, road and other modes of transport more efficiently, reducing

transit time and making supply chains more reliable, the institute said.

Calling DFCs and MMLPs a “real game-changer”, IIM Mumbai said that the logistics sector is expected to require deployment of around 11.5 million additional professionals by 2030.

The study comes days after Prime Minister Narendra Modi inaugurated three key sections of the Western Dedicated Freight Corridor (WDFC), com-



pleting the corridor between JNPT in Maharashtra and Dadri in Uttar Pradesh. The 1,506-km WDFC,

built exclusively for freight movement, has increased the railways’ cargo capacity, reduced transit times and made freight movement more predictable.

“The WDFC is a significant step towards transforming India’s freight and logistics network. I see this as a great infrastructure project by the government, with the potential to deliver substantial long-term benefits for businesses and the wider economy,” said

Manoj Kumar Tiwari, director at IIM Mumbai.

According to the study, the logistics industry contributes around 13% to GDP. Its market, estimated at ₹22.95 lakh crore in 2022, is projected to reach ₹47.12 lakh crore by 2030.

The institute said the next phase will need better coordination in infrastructure planning, simpler GST and regulatory procedures, easier business processes and digital integration.

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PUBLIC NOTICE

In terms of Regulation 22(6) of Securities and Exchange Board of India (Delisting of Equity shares) Regulations, 2009 / 32(5) of Securities and Exchange Board of India (Delisting of Equity shares) Regulations, 2021 ("Regulations") and as per the rules made under Section 21A of the Securities Contracts (Regulation) Act, 1956 and the Rules, Bye-Laws and Regulations of BSE Limited ("the Exchange"), **NOTICE** is hereby given that the companies given in the Table below are delisted from the platform of the Exchange w.e.f date mentioned therein.

Exchange had issued Public Notices in terms of Regulation 22(3) of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Delisting of Equity shares) Regulations, 2009/ 32(3) of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Delisting of Equity shares) Regulations, 2021 proposing to delist certain companies, which had been suspended for a period of more than 6 months on account of non-compliance with various clauses of the erstwhile Listing Agreement/SEBI (Listing Obligation and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 / Other reasons, from the Exchange. These companies had either failed to reply to the Exchange communications/ show cause notice issued by the Exchange or failed to take steps for revocation of suspension in the trading of their securities or had consented to go ahead with the compulsory delisting.

The Public Notice had provided 15 working days from the date of the Notice to any person aggrieved by the proposal to delist to submit representation in writing to the Delisting Committee of the Exchange.

The Delisting Committee of the Exchange, after considering the representations from companies and investors received during the mandated time and the facts in the matter passed Delisting Order in the case of the companies mentioned in the table below wherever applicable. The companies name along with addresses and promoters as per Exchange records, alongwith the Fair Value payable by Promoters to the public shareholders are given in table below:

Sr. No.	Scrip Code	Company Name	Address as per Exchange records	Fair Value To be Paid by the Promoters to the Public Shareholders (Rs.)	Names of the Promoters as per Exchange records	Effective date of delisting
1	527007	Atcom Technologies Ltd *	Flat No. 5, Sannidhan, Plot No. 145, Indulal D Bhuva Marg, Wadala, Mumbai - 400031, Maharashtra	Nil	Vineet Doshi HUF, Vineet A Doshi, Sharad A Doshi, Vikram A Doshi	August 31, 2026
2	541151	Ridings Consulting Engineers India Ltd	Office No. F-24, Pankaj Grand Plaza, First Floor, Mayur Vihar-I, Delhi - 110091, Delhi	1.47	Ishan Baveja, Harshit Bavija, Mehak Baveja, Achla Baveja, Shelly Baveja, Suman, Praveen Kumar Baveja, Anil Kumar Baveja, Sudhir Kumar Baveja, Sain Ditta Baveja	August 31, 2026

Note:

*The Company is delisted in terms of Securities and Exchange Board of India (Delisting of Equity shares) Regulations, 2009.

The names of the promoters shown above are based on records available with the Exchange or received from the concerned ROCs/RTAs/Depositories.

The company is advised to note that the consequences of compulsory delisting include:

1) As per SEBI (Delisting of Equity Shares) Regulations, 2009:-

- The securities of the company cease to be listed and therefore are not available for trading on the platform of the Exchange.
- Promoters of this delisted company would be required to purchase the shares from the public shareholders as per the fair value determined by the independent valuer appointed by the Exchange.
- Further, in terms of Regulation 24(1) of SEBI (Delisting of Equity Shares) Regulations, 2009, the delisted company, its whole-time directors, its promoters and the companies promoted by any of them shall not directly or indirectly access the securities market or seek listing for any equity shares for a period of 10 years from the date of compulsory delisting.
- As per provisions of Regulation 24(2) of the SEBI (Delisting of Equity Shares), Regulations, 2009, in case of companies whose fair value is positive –

- (a) such a company and the depositories shall not effect transfer, by way of sale, pledge, etc., of any of the equity shares held by the promoters/ promoter group and the corporate benefits like dividend, rights, bonus shares, split, etc. shall be frozen for all the equity shares held by the promoters/ promoter group, till the promoters of such company provide an exit option to the public shareholders in compliance with sub-regulation (3) of regulation 23, as certified by the concerned recognized stock exchange;
- (b) the promoters and whole-time directors of the compulsorily delisted company shall also not be eligible to become directors of any listed company till the exit option as stated in clause (a) above is provided.

- In terms of Regulation 23(3) of SEBI (Delisting of Equity Shares) Regulations, 2009, the promoter of the company shall acquire delisted equity shares from the public shareholders by paying them the value determined by the valuer within three months of the date of delisting from the recognised stock exchange, subject to their option of retaining their shares.

2) As per SEBI (Delisting of Equity Shares) Regulations, 2021:-

- The securities of the companies cease to be listed and therefore are not available for trading on the platform of the Exchange.
- Promoters of these delisted companies will be required to purchase the shares from the public shareholders as per the fair value determined by the independent valuer appointed by the Exchange.
- Further, in terms of Regulation 34(1) of SEBI (Delisting of Equity Shares) Regulations, 2021, the delisted company, its whole-time directors, person(s) responsible for ensuring compliance with securities law, its promoters and the companies promoted by any of them shall not directly or indirectly access the securities market or seek listing for any equity shares or act as an intermediary in the securities market for a period of 10 years from the date of compulsory delisting.
- As per provisions of Regulation 34(2) of the SEBI (Delisting of Equity Shares), Regulations, 2021, in case of companies whose fair value is positive –
 - (a) such a company and the depositories shall not effect transfer, by way of sale, pledge, etc., of any of the equity shares held by the promoters/ promoter group and the corporate benefits like dividend, rights, bonus shares, split, etc. shall be frozen for all the equity shares held by the promoters/ promoter group, till the promoters of such company provide an exit option to the public shareholders in compliance with sub-regulation (4) of regulation 33, as certified by the concerned recognized stock exchange;
 - (b) the promoters and whole-time directors and person(s) responsible for ensuring compliance with securities law, of the compulsorily delisted company shall also not be eligible to become directors of any listed company till the exit option as stated in clause (a) above is provided.
- In terms of Regulation 33(4) of SEBI (Delisting of Equity Shares) Regulations, 2021, the promoter(s) of the company shall acquire the delisted equity shares from the public shareholders by paying them the value determined by the valuer, within three months of the date of delisting from the recognized stock exchange, subject to the option of the public shareholders to retain their shares.
- In terms of Regulation 33(5) of SEBI (Delisting of Equity Shares) Regulations, 2021, the promoter shall be liable to pay interest at the rate of ten percent per annum to all the shareholders, who offer their shares under the compulsory delisting offer, if the price payable in terms of sub-regulation (3) of Regulation 33 is not paid to all the shareholders within the time specified under sub-regulation (4).

3) Further, these companies have been moved to the Dissemination Board of the Exchange.

4) It may be noted that the onus of giving exit to the public shareholders and providing information to the stock exchanges for fair valuation is on the promoters of the company. In case exit is not provided by the promoters, appropriate action would be taken against such entities.

For and on behalf of BSE Ltd.
September 12, 2026.